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DALAL STREET INVESTMENT JOURNAL

DEMOCRATIZING WEALTH CREATION

May 04 - 17, 2026 ■ Pages 68 ■ www.dsij.in ₹150

India's Best PSU Awards INSIDE

Cover Story

The Green Shift: Renewable Stocks Charge Ahead

Analysis

Honasa Consumer Ltd.

ISSN 0971-7579

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Vol. 41 No. 12

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ONGC
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Invest in diverse assets for a balanced portfolio.

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DALAL STREET INVESTMENT JOURNAL
DEMOCRATIZING WEALTH CREATION
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Spotlight sections are advertorials provided by the company & carried on "as is" basis.

Editor's Keyboard

When Uncertainty Becomes the Greatest Asset

April 2026 has placed Indian equities at a familiar, yet uncomfortable, crossroads. Global markets are once again grappling with geopolitical uncertainty, as the U.S.-Iran conflict and disruptions around the Strait of Hormuz have revived fears of an energy shock. With Brent crude still trading above USD 100 per barrel, sentiment has turned fragile, forcing investors to confront an old market dilemma, should one retreat when fear rises, or accumulate when valuations begin to reflect panic?

History offers a clear lesson. Some of the best investment opportunities are created not in comfort, but in confusion. Durable bull markets often find their base when pessimism peaks, weak hands exit, and long-term investors begin separating structural strength from short-term noise. For India, the current phase must be viewed through that lens. The country is facing external pressure, but it is not standing on weak ground. A decade of reforms, deeper domestic markets, stronger institutional frameworks and a proactive Reserve Bank of India have given the economy far greater shock-absorbing capacity than in earlier crisis periods.

The energy shock risk is real. A blockade or sustained disruption in the Strait of Hormuz can push crude prices higher, strain logistics and affect margins across sectors. Yet, India in 2026 is far better placed than it was during previous external crises. Foreign exchange reserves are stronger, oil intensity relative to GDP has reduced, and policy response mechanisms are more coordinated.

Government intervention, fiscal flexibility and continued infrastructure spending provide a meaningful buffer. The ability to absorb external shocks without abandoning domestic capital expenditure is one of the biggest changes in India's macro story. The more important market development is the ongoing rotation from export-linked uncertainty towards domestic structural growth. Manufacturing, defence, power transmission, renewable energy, infrastructure and select capital goods businesses are benefiting from visible policy support and funded capex programmes. They are backed by government priorities, corporate order books and multi-year spending visibility. This makes the risk-reward equation more attractive compared with sectors still dependent on a revival in global demand.

The message for investors is not to abandon quality export franchises, but to recognise where leadership is shifting. In the current environment, domestic growth themes offer a cleaner earnings runway. Renewable energy, infrastructure, capital goods and select PSUs are all part of this broader transition, where policy intent, execution visibility and market opportunity are beginning to align. This time, our cover story explores in detail how India's renewable energy journey has moved beyond policy ambition and entered the realm of market reality. From solar manufacturers and green power producers to utilities steadily shifting towards cleaner portfolios, the listed space is now beginning to mirror India's energy transition. However, the real opportunity lies in identifying companies where growth potential, execution capability, reasonable valuations and business resilience come together.

Continuing our tradition of celebrating the institutions that shape India's corporate landscape, this special edition of DSIJ highlights the contribution and performance of leading PSUs. From nation-building and infrastructure to energy security and financial inclusion, PSUs remain central to India's growth story. This issue honours select PSUs for their achievements while helping retail investors understand the opportunities, risks and perspective needed to invest in them wisely.

This is not a market for panic. It is a market for discipline. Volatility may remain elevated, and geopolitical risk cannot be ignored. But India's structural story remains intact. The prudent strategy is to accumulate quality businesses in domestic growth sectors at reasonable valuations. Investors should focus on earnings visibility, balance sheet strength, policy tailwinds and long-term scalability. Uncertainty is uncomfortable, but it is often the price paid for superior returns. For disciplined investors, the current correction may not be a warning to exit. It may be the opportunity to prepare for the next phase of India's equity journey.

RAJESH V PADODE
Managing Director & Editor

DALAL STREET INVESTMENT JOURNAL
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Bet on Power Stocks Now?

I recently came across the concept of seasonal investing and found it quite compelling. Given the ongoing intense heatwaves across the country, would it be prudent to consider this strategy for power sector stocks at this stage?

- Abhijeet Panse

Editor Responds: *Thank you for writing to us. Seasonal investing can be a useful tactical approach, especially in sectors like power that tend to see demand spikes during extreme weather conditions. Heatwaves typically drive higher electricity consumption due to increased cooling needs, which can support short-term revenue visibility for power companies.*

However, such trends are often anticipated and priced in by the market well in advance. Rather than chasing the theme purely based on seasonality, it is important to evaluate fundamentals such as capacity addition, fuel linkages, and balance sheet strength. A selective approach focusing on fundamentally strong players, rather than a broad seasonal bet, would be a more prudent strategy for investors in this space.

Write to us at editorial@dsij.in

Recommendations

Company/Scheme	Reco.	Price (₹)	Column	Page No
Amber Enterprises India	Buy	8,107.80	Kerbside	53
Aster DM Healthcare	Buy	719.80	Technicals	18
CESC	Buy	188.15	Kerbside	53
CG Power and Industrial Solutions	Buy	820.40	Kerbside	53
GE Power India	Buy	556.10	Kerbside	53
Honasa Consumer	Hold	347.55	Analysis	50
Nestle India	Buy	1416.30	Technicals	18
Olectra Greentech	Buy	1,234.70	Hot Chips	14
Privi Speciality Chemicals	Buy	3,259.90	Choice Scrip	10
Samvardhana Motherson International	Buy	127.85	Low Priced Scrip	12
Strides Pharma Science	Buy	1,097.55	Hot Chips	14

BP - Book Profit • **BPP** - Book Partial Profits • **BL** - Book Loss

IT Sell-Off Overshadows Gains

Range-bound markets reflected caution, with sharp IT declines offset by strength in power and defensive segments amid ongoing global uncertainty.

Domestic markets remained largely range-bound over the past fortnight, as investors adopted a cautious, wait-and-watch approach amid persistent geopolitical uncertainties despite the ceasefire. The benchmark indices, BSE Sensex and Nifty 50, started the period on a positive note with modest consecutive gains, but sentiment soon turned, with markets witnessing three straight sessions of notable declines toward the end of the period, largely driven by weakness in the information technology sector.

The broader market indices, BSE 150 Mid-cap and BSE 250 Small-cap, provided a degree of comfort to investors, registering gains of around 3-4 per cent during the period. On the sectoral front, trends remained mixed, reflecting selective participation across segments. The power sector emerged as a clear outperformer, with the BSE Power index rallying 11 per cent. This sharp uptrend was driven by a structural shift towards electrification, particularly amid concerns over potential disruptions in oil and gas supplies due to prevailing geopolitical tensions.

Additionally, seasonal factors played a supportive role, as rising electricity demand linked to the onset of summer and expectations of intense heatwaves further strengthened the sector's outlook, keeping investor sentiment firmly positive toward power stocks. Investors once again gravitated towards defensive segments such as healthcare and FMCG, seeking stability amid current market uncertainties.

The last day of the fortnight turned out to be a brutal session for the Indian IT pack, with the BSE IT index plunging more than 5 per cent in a single day, marking one of its sharpest declines in recent times. Heavyweights such as Infosys, HCL Technologies, and Tata Consultancy Services were among the worst hit, with Infosys alone tumbling nearly 7 per cent. The sharp sell-off was largely triggered by disappointing Q4 earnings and, more importantly, cautious forward guidance from leading IT companies.

Management commentary pointed to continued weakness in discretionary spending across key markets such as the U.S. and Europe, as clients delayed or scaled down large transformation deals amid macroeconomic uncertainties. In other developments, Brent crude hovered around USD 105 per barrel, fuelling concerns over a potential uptick in inflation. At the same time, the absence of any meaningful progress toward de-escalation in the Iran-Israel-U.S. conflict kept global sentiment cautious.

The Indian rupee remained under pressure, trading near 94 against the U.S. dollar. On the institutional front, foreign institutional investors (FIIs) continued to remain net sellers, offloading equities worth around ₹17,400 crore. In contrast, domestic institutional investors (DIIs) extended support to the markets; however, the pace of inflows has moderated significantly compared to earlier periods, indicating a more measured approach. Stay tuned for more updates.

Performance Of Indices

Indices	Apr. 13, 2026	Apr. 24, 2026	Gain/Loss (%)
Power	7,286.60	8,067.49	10.72
FMCG	17,831.48	18,763.84	5.23
BSE 250 Smallcap	6,261.45	6,532.53	4.33
Metal	40,765.04	41,927.49	2.85
BSE 150 Midcap	15,623.78	16,036.82	2.64
Healthcare	42,619.40	43,616.92	2.34
Realty	5,890.14	6,022.14	2.24
Oil & Gas	26,681.26	27,038.25	1.34
Bankex	62,984.89	63,188.31	0.32
Nifty 50	24,050.60	23,897.95	-0.63
BSE Sensex	77,550.25	76,664.21	-1.14
Auto	58,714.39	56,681.68	-3.46
IT	29,902.28	27,648.74	-7.54

Net Investment In Equity Markets (₹/Cr)

Date	FIIs	DIIs
Apr. 24, 2026	-8,827.87	4,700.71
Apr. 23, 2026	-3,254.71	941.35
Apr. 22, 2026	-2,078.36	-1,048.17
Apr. 21, 2026	-1,918.99	2,221.27
Apr. 20, 2026	-1,059.93	2,966.89
Apr. 17, 2026	683.2	-4,721.48
Apr. 16, 2026	382.36	-3,427.75
Apr.15, 2026	666.15	-568.98
Apr. 13, 2026	-1,983.18	2,432.30
Total	**-17,391.33**	**3,496.14**


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Privi Speciality Chemicals Ltd.

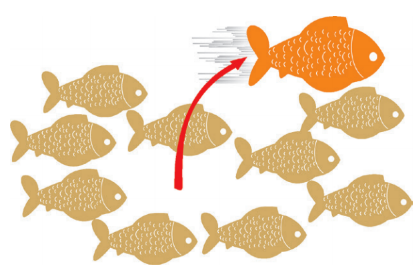
LEADER WITH STRONG GROWTH SCENT

HERE IS WHY

Strong Earnings Momentum

Capacity Expansion & Product Innovation

Global Client Relationships



CHOICE SCRIP

1 YEAR INVESTMENT HORIZON

The global chemicals market is valued at around USD 4.7 trillion, making it one of the largest industrial sectors worldwide. India accounts for only about 4.3 per cent of this market, ranking fifth globally. Within this, speciality chemicals contribute roughly USD 36 billion, or 18 per cent of the total, and are expanding at a healthy pace of 12–16 per cent CAGR. A key segment within speciality chemicals is flavours and fragrances which continues to see steady demand, supported by rising consumption of personal care and household products globally.

One such company well positioned in this space is Privi Speciality Chemicals Ltd (Privi), which we are recommending in this issue of Choice Scrip. Privi is among India's leading manufacturers, suppliers, and exporters of aroma and fragrance chemicals used in soaps, detergents, shampoos, and fine fragrances. The company has a diversified product portfolio of over 75 aroma chemicals and caters to leading global fragrance players, benefiting from long-standing relationships and high entry barriers in the segment.

In Q3FY26, on a consolidated basis, Privi reported revenue of ₹605 crore, registering a growth of around 23.18 per cent YoY. Net profit came in at ₹75 crore, reflecting a strong growth of 68 per cent YoY. The improvement in margins has been driven by a higher share of value-added products, operational efficiencies, and a better product mix.

Approximately 70 per cent of Privi's business is under long-term contracts, providing strong revenue visibility and stability. Its products are largely used in essential FMCG applications, making demand relatively resilient across economic cycles. The company also benefits from backward integration and a strong global customer base, which supports margin stability and cost efficiency.

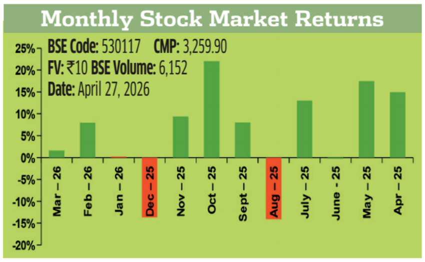
On the growth front, Privi continues to execute its long-term expansion strategy aimed at achieving its 5k:1k vision, ₹5,000 crore revenue and ₹1,000 crore EBITDA over the next 3–4 years. The company has outlined a capex plan of around ₹1,200 crore across three phases, focused on capacity expansion, new product additions, and high-value speciality chemicals. This capex will be funded through a mix of internal accruals and borrowings, indicating a balanced funding approach.

The company is also strengthening its innovation pipeline through investments in green chemistry, biotechnology, and intellectual property, which could open up new growth avenues. Its joint venture with Givaudan (PRIGIV) has started contributing positively at the EBITDA level and is expected to turn profitable at the PAT level in the coming periods, further supporting growth.

From a valuation perspective, the stock is currently trading at a P/E of 42.3x, which is higher than the industry average of 28.4x, but below its three-year median of 51.1x. The PEG ratio of 1.64 suggests that valuations are broadly aligned with its growth trajectory. The company maintains strong financial quality with a Piotroski score of 8. Over the past three years, the company has delivered a sales CAGR of 14.4 per cent and a profit CAGR of 25.8 per cent, reflecting steady growth and improving profitability.

Considering the strong earnings momentum, improving margin profile, ongoing capacity expansion, and long-term growth visibility, Privi Speciality Chemicals remains well positioned to benefit from structural growth in the speciality chemicals and fragrance segment. With earnings upgrades and execution visibility improving, we recommend a **BUY.**

Monthly Stock Market Returns



Shareholding Pattern (%) as of December 2025

Promoters	60.60
Institutions	12.04
Public	27.36
Total	100.00

Last Five Quarters (₹/Cr) (Consolidated)

Particulars	Dec-24	Mar-25	June-25	Sept-25	Dec-25
Total Income	490.87	613.55	558.81	678.71	604.64
Other Income	2.19	14.82	8.99	0.11	6.50
Operating Profit	115.00	147.42	141.05	182.14	157.85
Interest	21.75	22.57	23.66	21.48	18.57
Net Profit	44.48	63.98	57.55	90.21	74.85
Equity	39.00	39.00	39.00	39.00	39.00

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LPG Cavern Project, Mangalore
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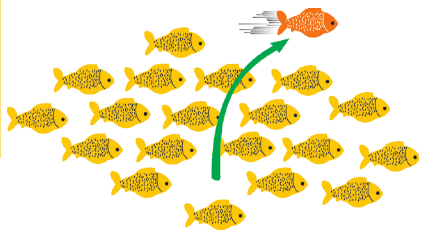
HERE IS WHY

Electrification driving higher content per vehicle

Aerospace and electronics scaling rapidly

Strong order book ensures long-term visibility



LOW PRICED SCRIP

1 YEAR INVESTMENT HORIZON

The auto industry is in the middle of a quiet revolution. Electric cars are reshaping city streets, factories are getting smarter, and the companies that make the parts, not just the cars, are becoming the real architects of modern mobility. Component makers are no longer just suppliers. They are strategic partners, co-designing vehicles, managing entire assembly lines, and expanding into industries unimaginable a decade ago. The old playbook, make a part, ship it, repeat, is gone. What the industry demands now is scale, agility, and the ability to follow customers without missing a beat.

The global automotive industry produced approximately 89.8 million light vehicles in FY25, declining 1 per cent year-on-year due to sluggish demand in Europe and North America. The outlook is turning. Production is projected to recover to 91 million units in FY26 and 93 million in FY27, driven by India and China. Electrification is accelerating this shift, with EVs requiring far more wiring, electronics, and integrated components per vehicle, expanding the addressable market for suppliers meaningfully.

Many investors have never heard of Samvardhana Motherson International Limited (Motherson). Yet the car you drive likely has their fingerprints all over it: the mirror on your door, the bumper, the wiring running quietly through your dashboard. Born in India over five decades ago, Motherson has grown into one of the world's most formidable manufacturers, with revenues of ₹1.13 lakh crore in FY25, spanning 47 countries. It chases customers, not headlines.

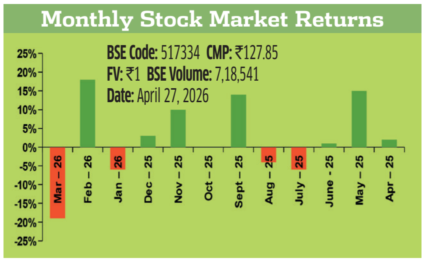
Its vision systems division is one of the world's largest makers of exterior mirrors. The modules and polymers unit produces bumpers, dashboards, and full interior systems for leading European OEMs. The wiring harness division powers millions of vehicles on the road every year. Its integrated assemblies business manages complex vehicle assembly directly on OEM production lines, making Motherson a rare Tier-0.5 supplier. The aerospace unit has recently been empanelled as a Tier-1 Airbus supplier. Acquisitions of Nexans Autoelectric and Yutaka Giken add further global scale, alongside fast-growing consumer electronics and healthcare businesses.

Electrification expands content per vehicle, directly benefiting Motherson's core. Consumer electronics capacity targets 16 million units annually, with a third plant doubling that by Q3 FY27. Aerospace revenues are growing at 40 per cent year-on-year. 12 Greenfield plants are under construction across India, Morocco, UAE, and Poland. Vision 2030 targets USD 108 billion in revenues at 40 per cent ROCE, building on growth from USD 9 billion to USD 25.7 billion in just five years.

Q3 FY26 was a landmark quarter for Motherson, with its highest-ever quarterly revenue of ₹31,409 crore, a 14 per cent jump year-on-year, delivered in an environment where global vehicle production was actually declining. Profits grew even faster, rising 21 per cent to ₹1,061 crore, supported by operational improvements in Europe, lower finance costs, and strong contributions from joint ventures. ROCE stands at 17.2 per cent.

At 38x P/E against a five-year median of 41.2x, Motherson trades at a modest discount to its own history. A PEG of 0.63 suggests earnings growth remains underpriced by the market. The dividend yield of 0.45 per cent reflects a company choosing aggressive reinvestment over near-term distribution, the right call given the opportunity ahead. With 12 Greenfield plants coming online, acquisitions closing in Japan and Europe, and consumer electronics and aerospace scaling rapidly, the earnings outlook is compelling. We recommend **BUY**.

Monthly Stock Market Returns



Shareholding Pattern (%) as of March 2026

Promoters	48.60
Institutions	33.58
Public	17.82
Total	100.00

Last Five Quarters (₹/Cr) (Consolidated)

Particulars	Dec-25	Sept-25	June-25	Mar-25	April-24
Net Sales	31409.39	30172.97	30212.00	29316.83	27665.92
Other Income	51.37	121.22	80.48	116.39	111.20
Operating Profit	3094.44	2731.94	2342.03	2759.25	2797.00
Interest	341.07	386.54	425.04	425.62	466.13
Net Profit	931.73	700.00	481.82	983.33	881.19
Equity	1055.44	1055.44	703.63	703.63	703.63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HOT CHIPS
15 DAYS INVESTMENT HORIZON

The scrips in this column have been recommended with a 15-day investment horizon in mind and carry high risk. Therefore, investors are advised to take into account their risk appetite before investing, as fundamentals may or may not back the recommendations.

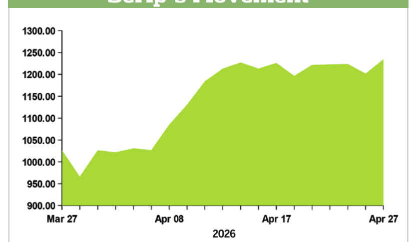
Olectra Greentech Ltd.

CMP - ₹1,234.70

BSE CODE	Volume	Face Value	Target	Stoploss
532439	26,885	₹4	₹1,335 - ₹1,360	₹1,150 (CLS)

Olectra Greentech Ltd is a pioneer in electric bus manufacturing and composite insulators in India. The company focuses on sustainable mobility through high-performance electric buses and green technologies. During Q3FY26, the company reported a strong performance, with revenue surging 29 per cent year-on-year to ₹664 crore. Profitability remained steady at ₹47 crore, in line with the same quarter last year. The company continues to secure strong order inflows from government bodies, reflecting its leadership in India's electric bus segment. In February, it received a major order from Telangana State Road Transport Corporation (TGSRTC) for supply, operation, and maintenance of 1,085 electric buses. The value of the supply for these electric buses is estimated to be around ₹1,800 crore. With the government's increasing focus on renewable and clean mobility, the company is well positioned for sustained growth.

Scrip's Movement



Last Seven Days' Volume Table (No. of Shares)

Days	Volume
Apr 20, 2026	37,096
Apr 21, 2026	55,625
Apr 22, 2026	30,757
Apr 23, 2026	25,114
Apr 24, 2026	21,949
Apr 27, 2026	26,885

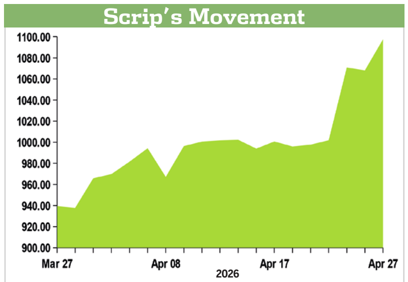
Given its robust order book and favourable industry tailwinds, we recommend **BUY.**

Strides Pharma Science Ltd.

CMP - ₹1,097.55

BSE CODE	Volume	Face Value	Target	Stoploss
532531	22,412	₹10	₹1,185- ₹1,205	₹1,020 (CLS)

Scrip's Movement



Last Seven Days' Volume Table (No. of Shares)

Days	Volume
Apr 20, 2026	9,108
Apr 21, 2026	5,824
Apr 22, 2026	5,469
Apr 23, 2026	27,020
Apr 24, 2026	14,863
Apr 27, 2026	22,412

Strides Pharma Science Ltd is a global pharmaceutical company engaged in the development and manufacturing of niche generic formulations. It has a strong presence across regulated and emerging markets, with operations in over 100 countries. The company focuses on complex dosage forms, supported by a robust manufacturing and R&D infrastructure, driving its global growth strategy. The stock has recently witnessed strong buying interest, rallying 16-18 per cent over the past month and delivering around 35 per cent returns over the last six months, showcasing resilience amid a weak broader market. As of March 2026, DIIs increased their stake to 14.44 per cent, while renowned investor Mukul Agrawal held a 1.16 per cent stake. The company is poised for strong growth driven by improving U.S. generics traction, expanding product pipeline, and enhanced operational efficiencies. Strategic focus on regulated markets and margin recovery further strengthens earnings visibility, supporting a positive future outlook; hence we recommend **BUY.**

(Closing price as of April 27, 2026)

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CIN : L33121GJ1994PLC022460 I **E-Mail:** cs@transformerindia.com I **Website:** www.transformerindia.com

Statement of Standalone Audited Financial Results for the Quarter and Financial Year ended March 31, 2026

(₹ in Crore, except per share data)

Sr No	Particulars	Quarter Ended			Year Ended	
		31.03.2026 (Audited)	31.12.2025 (Unaudited)	31.03.2025 (Audited)	31.03.2026 (Audited)	31.03.2025 (Audited)
1	**Income**					
	a Revenue from Operations	752.33	704.21	647.31	2,395.49	1,950.14
	b Other Income	22.42	5.66	7.94	56.85	32.78
	Total Income	**774.75**	**709.87**	**655.25**	**2,452.34**	**1,982.92**
2	**Expenses**					
	a Cost of Materials Consumed	543.40	417.41	444.99	1,763.00	1,421.90
	b Purchases of Stock-in-trade	0.15	0.34	1.89	1.94	5.04
	c Changes in Inventories of Finished Goods & Work-In-Progress	(13.40)	82.21	(1.66)	(79.43)	(42.68)
	d Employee Benefits Expenses	29.78	17.61	20.62	85.09	52.29
	e Finance Cost	12.62	12.36	13.33	44.92	48.38
	f Depreciation & Amortization Expenses	5.26	5.67	6.27	23.20	24.28
	g Other Expenses	97.92	78.30	77.68	311.78	229.50
	Total Expenses	**675.73**	**613.90**	**563.12**	**2,150.50**	**1,738.71**
3	**Profit before exceptional items and tax (1-2)**	**99.02**	**95.97**	**92.13**	**301.84**	**244.21**
4	**Exceptional Items**					
	Reversal of impairment on Investments	-	-	3.24	-	3.24
5	**Profit Before Tax (3+4)**	**99.02**	**95.97**	**95.37**	**301.84**	**247.45**
6	**Tax Expense**					
	- Current Tax	26.12	28.72	26.37	80.46	68.01
	- Deferred Tax	(4.57)	(3.79)	(7.57)	(5.96)	(8.13)
	- Tax Adjustment of Earlier Years	-	0.01	(0.01)	1.91	0.01
	Total Tax Expense	**21.55**	**24.94**	**18.79**	**76.41**	**59.88**
7	**Profit for the period (5-6)**	**77.47**	**71.03**	**76.59**	**225.43**	**187.57**
8	**Other Comprehensive Income**					
	- items that will not be reclassified to profit or loss					
	- Equity Instrument through Other Comprehensive Income					
	- Remeasurement of Defined Benefit Obligation	(0.21)	0.10	-	0.09	0.20
	- Income tax liability of items that will not be reclassified to profit or loss	0.05	(0.05)	-	(0.05)	(0.05)
	- items that will be reclassified to profit or loss					
9	**Total Comprehensive Income (7+8)**	**77.31**	**71.08**	**76.59**	**225.47**	**187.71**
10	**Paid-up Equity Share Capital of Face Value of ₹1/- each**	**30.02**	**30.02**	**30.02**	**30.02**	**30.02**
11	**Other Equity**	**-**	**-**	**-**	**1,410.17**	**1,180.40**
12	**Earning Per Share (EPS)***					
	a Basic EPS (in ₹)	2.58	2.37	2.58	7.51	6.31
	b wDiluted EPS (in ₹)	2.58	2.37	2.58	7.51	6.31
	* Not annualised for quarter ended					

Notes :

1. The standalone financial results of the Company for the quarter and year ended March 31, 2026 have been reviewed and recommended by the Audit Committee and approved by the Board of Directors in their respective meetings held on April 21, 2026.
2. These financial results have been prepared in accordance with the Indian Accounting Standards (Ind AS) notified under section 133 of the Companies Act, 2013, read together with the Companies (Indian Accounting Standards) Rules, 2015, as amended issued thereunder and other provisions of the Companies Act 2013, as applicable and guidelines issued by the Securities and Exchange Board of India ("SEBI") and other recognised accounting principles and policies generally accepted in India to the extent possible. These financial results are presented in accordance with the requirements of Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 and circulars issued thereunder.
3. The financial results have been audited by the Statutory Auditors as required under Regulation 33 of SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements), Regulation, 2015. The Statutory Auditors have issued unmodified opinion on the standalone financial results for the year ended March 31, 2026.
4. The operations of the Company are limited to one segment, namely Manufacturing of Transformers. Accordingly, disclosure under Indian Accounting Standard (Ind AS) 108 on operating segments is not applicable to the Company.
5. The shareholders of the Company, at their meeting held on May 13, 2024, approved the 'TRIL Employee Stock Option Plan 2024' ("ESOP 2024" or "the Plan"), authorizing the grant of up to 42,76,922 employee stock options, to be issued from time to time in one or more tranches, subject to requisite statutory approvals. The Company granted 26,32,968 employee stock options under the Plan on August 01, 2025. Out of these, 25,04,968 options carry an exercise price of ₹372 per option and 1,28,000 options carry an exercise price of ₹1. Each option, upon vesting and exercise in accordance with the terms of the Plan, entitles the holder to one equity share of the Company. In this regard, during the current quarter ₹3.78 crore and till end of this year total amount of ₹10.31 crore is recognised as an expense with a corresponding increase to share option outstanding account.
6. Potentially issuable equity shares arising from Employee Stock Options have not been included in the computation of diluted earnings per share as they are anti-dilutive for the period presented.
7. The Board of Directors at their meeting held on April 21, 2026 has recommended the final dividend of ₹0.25 per Equity Share.
8. The figures for the quarter ended March 31, 2026 are the balancing figures between audited figures in respect of the full financial year and the reviewed year-to-date figures up to the third quarter of the financial year.

For Transformers and Rectifiers (India) Limited

Satyen J. Mamtora
Managing Director & CEO
DIN : 00139984

Place : Ahmedabad
Date : April 21, 2026

NIFTY Index Chart Analysis

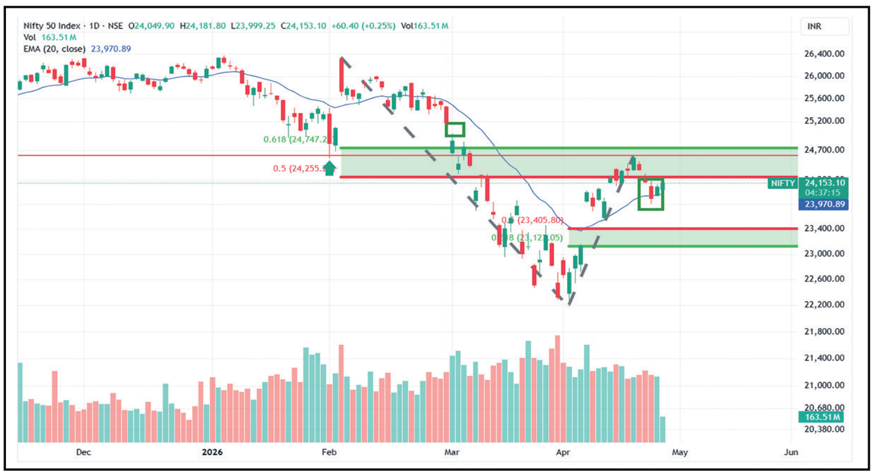
Nifty Must Sustain Above 24,320 for a Trending Upmove

Roadmap for the Next 15 Days			
Ideas	**Nifty Levels**	**Action to be Initiated**	**Probable Targets**
Resistance for the medium-term	24,220 — 24,320	Close above the level of 24,220 — 24,320 would be positive for Nifty	24,700 — 24,800
Support for the medium-term	23,814	Any slip below 23,814 on a closing basis would result into resumption of down move.	23,400

The Nifty 50 snapped its two-week winning streak last week, ending lower by 1.87 per cent amid profit booking in IT stocks and elevated crude oil prices, as the US-Iran situation remained unresolved. The pressure was more visible in the Nifty IT index, which declined nearly 10 per cent in a week. Muted Q4FY26 earnings, cautious growth guidance, slower client spending, delayed decision-making and weaker deal momentum weighed on the sector.

making follow-through buying crucial from here.

A key takeaway from Monday's session was the strong buying demand seen near the short-term 20-day EMA and the



However, the new week began on a positive note. The Nifty reclaimed the important psychological level of 24,000, while India VIX cooled off from higher levels. More importantly, broader markets participated in the recovery, leading to an improvement in market breadth.

On Monday, the index ended its three-day losing streak and closed higher by 0.81 per cent. On the daily chart, the Nifty formed a bullish-bodied candle. However, it traded within the range of the previous session, resulting in an inside candle formation.

This suggests that while buying interest has returned, the index is yet to display decisive strength. It continues to trade below its immediate resistance zone, important gap zone of 23,900–24,145. This indicates that buyers are still willing to step in at higher levels.

Going forward, a sustained move above Friday's high of 24,206 would confirm the end of the recent three-session corrective phase. Until that happens, the index may continue to consolidate within a broader range of 23,400–24,200, while reacting to geopolitical developments and the ongoing corporate earnings season.

The zone of 24,220–24,320 is likely to act as the immediate resistance area, as the 50-DMA is placed around this range. A sustained move above this zone could help the index form a higher low on the daily chart. In that case, Friday's swing low of 23,814 would become an important higher-low point.

For now, 23,814 remains the crucial support level, while 24,220–24,320 is the key resistance zone for the Nifty.

If the index breaches 23,814, the next important support is placed around 23,400. This level coincides with the 50 per cent Fibonacci retracement of the current up move from 22,183 to 24,602, along with the gap area of 23,555–23,154.

On the upside, a sustained move above 24,220–24,320 could open the door for a further rally towards 24,700–24,800.

The 14-period daily RSI has moved above the 50 mark, indicating some improvement in momentum. However, the hourly RSI continues to remain below 50, suggesting that short-term strength is not yet fully established.

Overall, April has been a strong month for the Nifty 50, with the index gaining nearly 8 per cent so far.

For the fortnight, market participants should adopt a cautious and defensive approach. Fresh aggressive buying should be avoided until the index shows signs of sustaining above key resistance levels.

The focus should remain on capital protection and selective stock-specific opportunities rather than broad-based exposure. Traders should stay nimble, follow stop losses strictly and avoid over-leveraging, as the market is likely to remain volatile and range-bound in the near term.

STOCK RECOMMENDATIONS

ASTER DM HEALTHCARE LTD. .... BUY .... CMP ₹719.80

BSE Code : 540975 | Target 1 .... ₹790 | Target 2 ..... ₹810 | Stoploss....₹670 (CLS)

Aster DM Healthcare is one of India's largest healthcare service providers, with a strong presence across primary, secondary, tertiary and quaternary care. The company operates 20 hospitals with 5,451 beds, along with 10 clinics, 203 pharmacies operated by Alfaone Retail Pharmacies Private Limited under brand licence from Aster, and 302 labs and patient experience centres across five states in India.

From a technical perspective, the stock has closed above the pivot point of a 22-week cup-and-handle like pattern and has also registered a fresh high close. Its Relative Strength line is at a new high, indicating clear outperformance. Volumes have remained elevated over the last five weeks, adding strength to the price action. The stock is trading well above all key moving averages, and these averages are also trending upward. The weekly Bollinger Bands are expanding, while the 20-DMA remains in an uptrend. The stock is currently trading 9.7 per cent above its 50-DMA, and the moving average ribbon continues to support the broader uptrend. Momentum indicators are also aligned in favour of the bulls. The MACD has generated a fresh bullish signal, while the RSI has shifted into the bullish zone across multiple time frames. The KST has also flashed a fresh bullish signal, and the Stochastic RSI remains positive. The Elder Impulse system has formed a strong bullish bar, further confirming strength in the setup. In short, the stock appears well-positioned for a bullish breakout. On the upside, it can test ₹790, followed by ₹810. A stop loss may be maintained at ₹670.

NESTLE INDIA LTD. .... BUY .... CMP ₹1,416.30

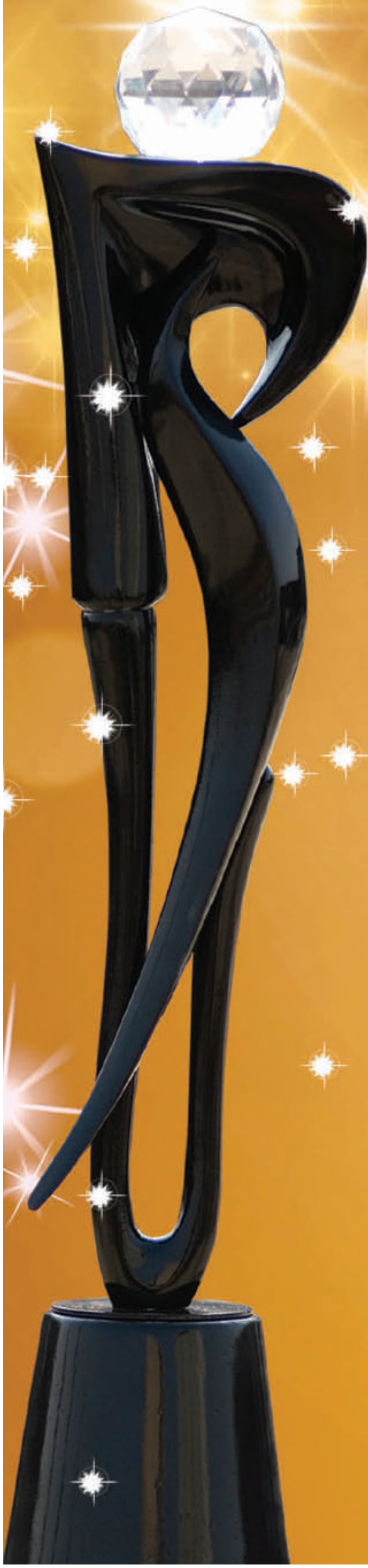
BSE Code : 500790 | Target 1 ...... ₹1,510 | Target 2 ..... ₹1,540 | Stoploss.....₹1,337 (CLS)

Nestlé India is a subsidiary of Switzerland-based Nestlé S.A. With nine manufacturing facilities, a wide network of co-packers and a strong distribution reach, the company offers Indian consumers a broad portfolio of global-standard products. Its key brands include Maggi noodles and sauces, Nescafé coffee, KitKat and Munch chocolates, Milkmaid dairy products, Cerelac infant nutrition, Everyday dairy whitener and Nestea. The stock has witnessed a breakout from an over two-year consolidation pattern on the weekly time frame, supported by above-average volumes. Technically, Nestlé India is comfortably placed above its key moving averages, reflecting strength in the broader structure. From an O'Neil Methodology perspective, the stock meets most of the key criteria. It has an EPS Rank of 82, which is considered a good score and reflects consistency in earnings. Its RS Rating stands at 79, which is fair but improving, indicating better recent price performance. Buyer Demand is rated A, supported by visible accumulation in recent sessions. The weekly RSI is in the bullish zone and has moved above its prior swing high. The weekly MACD histogram is showing rising bullish momentum. At the same time, the +DMI is moving higher and remains above both the -DMI and the ADX line, indicating improving trend strength. Overall, the setup looks attractive. On the upside, the stock has the potential to test ₹1,510 to ₹1,540. A stop loss may be kept at ₹1,337.

*LEGEND: ■ EMA - Exponential Moving Average. ■ MACD - Moving Average Convergence Divergence ■ RMI - Relative Momentum Index
■ ROC - Rate of Change ■ RSI - Relative Strength Index

(Closing price as of April 27, 2026)

Disclaimer : Above recommendations are based on various technical parameters and any fundamental input has not been considered for the recommendations. Follow strict stop loss for the recommendation.



DALAL STREET INVESTMENT JOURNAL

DEMOCRATIZING WEALTH CREATION

PRESENTS

India's BEST PUBLIC SECTOR *Undertakings*

Preface

India's PSU Renaissance: Stability, Scale and the Search for Value

There are moments in the market when an old story demands to be read again with fresh eyes. India's public sector undertakings, long viewed through the narrow lens of stability, dividends and government ownership, are today asking investors to look beyond the obvious. The PSU story is no longer merely about dependable balance sheets or defensive portfolios. It is about transformation, national ambition and the changing character of India's growth journey.

For decades, PSUs have occupied a unique place in the Indian economy. They have built banks in regions where private capital hesitated, powered homes and factories, laid the foundation for infrastructure, supported strategic sectors such as defence and energy, and carried the weight of policy execution at scale. In many ways, PSUs have not just participated in India's development; they have helped build its operating system.

Yet, for a long period, the market chose to ignore them. Between 2010 and 2020, many PSU stocks remained trapped under concerns of weak governance, policy overhang, inefficient capital allocation and subdued returns. Public sector banks battled asset quality stress. Energy companies dealt with pricing constraints. Capital goods and infrastructure-linked entities suffered from a weak investment cycle. What the market saw was not opportunity, but inertia.

Then came the turn.

From 2021 onwards, PSUs staged one of the most remarkable comebacks in recent market memory. Balance sheets improved, order books expanded, profitability strengthened and investor perception changed. Public sector banks regained credibility after years of clean-up. Defence and railway-linked PSUs found themselves at the heart of India's indigenisation and infrastructure push. Energy PSUs demonstrated resilience, cash flow strength and strategic relevance in a volatile world. Suddenly, the same companies that were once dismissed as slow-moving began to be recognised as critical beneficiaries of India's structural growth.

But markets, as always, have a way of testing conviction. The sharp rally was followed by correction, volatility and valuation debates. Some stocks moved ahead of fundamentals. Some pockets witnessed profit booking. Investors were forced to ask an important question: was the PSU rally only a phase, or was it the beginning of a broader re-rating?

This special issue attempts to answer that question with balance. We are not treating PSUs as a single, uniform basket. That would be too simplistic. The real opportunity lies in understanding the differences within the theme. Some PSUs enjoy strong order visibility. Some are improving return ratios. Some are sitting at the centre of India's defence, energy transition, banking, infrastructure or manufacturing ambitions. Others may still need to prove that market enthusiasm is backed by sustainable earnings.

At DSIJ, we believe the PSU opportunity must be approached with selectivity, discipline and context. The comeback is real, but so is the need for careful stock selection. Not every correction is an opportunity, and not every rally is justified. Investors must separate quality from noise, structural growth from cyclical excitement, and value creation from mere valuation catch-up.

Best Regards,
The Editorial Team

PSUs: The Comeback India Can't Ignore

The PSU space is no longer just about stability and dividends. Once seen as predictable and slow-moving, PSUs are now rewriting their market story. What was once dismissed is now being actively debated, tracked, and invested in, signalling a shift that deserves a closer look

The Backbone of Critical Sectors

To understand the PSU story, one must begin with their role in the economy. These enterprises are not just companies. They are extensions of policy intent. In sectors like banking, energy, defence, railways, and infrastructure, PSUs form the core operating framework. Public sector banks continue to drive credit growth in semi-urban and rural regions, often stepping in where private lenders tread cautiously. Energy PSUs dominate oil exploration, refining, and power generation, ensuring stability in supply chains that are critical for growth. Defence PSUs are at the heart of India's push for indigenisation. Railways and infrastructure-linked entities remain central to the government's capital expenditure cycle.

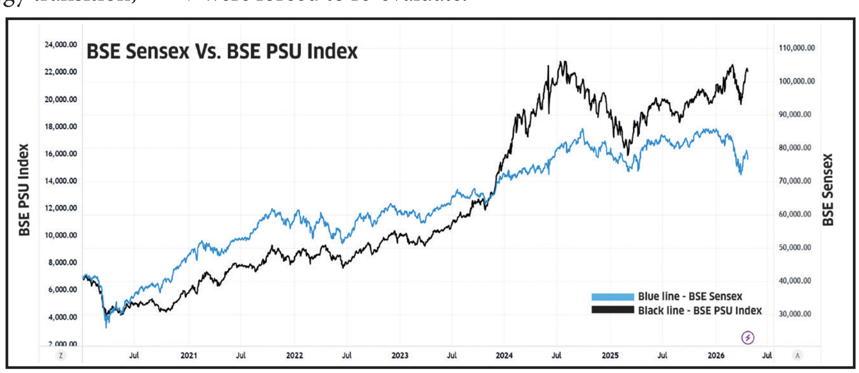
This presence is not accidental. It is by design. India's development model has relied on PSUs to build capacity where private capital was either unwilling or unable to invest at scale. And this role is only becoming more important. As the country pushes toward manufacturing expansion, energy transition, and infrastructure modernisation, PSUs are once again at the frontlines. Whether it is building renewable capacity, executing large engineering projects, or supporting defence exports, these companies are deeply embedded in India's long-term growth blueprint.

The Long Period of Neglect

Despite their importance, PSU stocks were largely ignored for years. Between 2010 and 2020, many PSU stocks delivered muted returns. Issues such as governance concerns, inefficient capital allocation, and policy overhang weighed on investor sentiment. Public sector banks struggled with asset quality problems. Energy companies faced pricing constraints. Capital goods PSUs were hit by weak private capex. Valuations compressed, sometimes to levels that did not reflect the underlying asset strength. For a long time, PSUs were seen as value traps rather than value opportunities.

The Rally That Changed Perception

The tide began to turn around 2021. What followed was one of the most remarkable rallies in the Indian equity market. PSU stocks across sectors skyrocketed sharply between 2021 and mid-2024. The rally was broad-based and not limited to a handful of names. Public sector banks were among the biggest beneficiaries. After years of cleaning up balance sheets, they began reporting improving asset quality, stronger credit growth, and better profitability. Investors who had written them off were forced to re-evaluate.



Cover Story

Capital goods and infrastructure-linked PSUs also gained traction. With the government stepping up capital expenditure, order books expanded significantly. Companies involved in railways, defence manufacturing, and engineering services saw strong earnings visibility. Energy PSUs rode on a combination of factors including stable cash flows, attractive dividend yields, and improving refining margins. In a volatile global environment, their earnings resilience stood out.

There was also a shift in narrative. PSUs were no longer just about dividends and defensive positioning. They became growth stories. Domestic institutional investors increased their exposure. Retail participation surged, especially through direct equity and thematic interest. The rally was also supported by a broader re-rating of India as a growth market. In many ways, the PSU rally reflected a convergence of fundamentals and sentiment.

From Euphoria to Reality Check

No rally moves in a straight line. By the second half of 2024, PSU stocks began to see a sharp correction. The trigger was not a single event but a mix of global shocks, policy shifts, and valuation concerns coming together at the same time. Valuations had expanded significantly in a short span. In several cases, price gains had run ahead of earnings visibility, leading to inevitable profit booking. At the same time, global developments turned less supportive.

Geopolitical tensions kept energy markets volatile, central banks stayed cautious on interest rates, and supply chain disruptions, which had eased earlier, also saw intermittent flare-ups, adding to uncertainty for sectors dependent on imports and logistics. Domestically, there were subtle but important shifts. The government's continued focus on infrastructure remained intact, but there was a gradual tilt toward boosting consumption through targeted measures.

This created some rotation in market preferences, with investors reassessing the pace of earnings growth in infrastructure-heavy PSU segments. Sector-specific concerns added to the pressure. Defence stocks saw intermittent corrections after a strong run, largely due to valuation debates. Infrastructure-linked PSUs faced questions around execution timelines and margin sustainability. The correction was sharp in pockets. Some stocks saw meaningful drawdowns, testing investor conviction. But what stood out was the resilience.

The Recovery Phase

Even as PSU stocks corrected, the underlying fundamentals remained largely intact. This set the stage for a recovery. During 2025, PSU stocks began to stabilise and move higher again. The recovery was more measured compared to the earlier rally, but it was supported by earnings visibility. Public sector banks continued to report improving return ratios. Credit growth remained healthy, particularly in retail and MSME segments. Asset quality metrics improved further, reducing concerns around legacy issues. Infrastructure, defence and capital goods PSUs benefited from sustained government spending.

Energy PSUs adapted to a changing landscape. Investments in renewable energy and diversification strategies began to reflect in their long-term outlook. Interestingly, the recovery also saw participation from different segments. Large-cap PSUs led the initial phase, given their liquidity and institutional interest. Mid-cap and smaller PSUs followed, driven by retail participation and thematic bets. Regionally, stocks linked to infrastructure development in emerging industrial corridors saw increased attention, reflecting the geographic spread of economic activity.

Best-Performing PSU Stocks in the Last One Year

Company Name	Latest Market Cap. (₹ Cr.)	1 Year Returns (%)
National Aluminium Company Ltd.	79,057.78	164.51
Hindustan Copper Ltd.	52,367.69	152.38
Shipping Corporation Of India Ltd.	13,587.83	69.80
Chennai Petroleum Corporation Ltd.	15,917.14	58.71
KIOCL Ltd.	24,358.31	57.52
Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers Ltd.	33,869.42	53.29
Bharat Electronics Ltd.	3,23,640.42	52.52
Steel Authority Of India Ltd.	73,015.02	48.71
Bharat Heavy Electricals Ltd.	1,18,167.32	43.34
Engineers India Ltd.	13,688.55	34.94

Why PSUs Still Matter for Investors

Following a notable recovery, the BSE PSU Index, a key gauge of leading public sector companies, is currently trading just 3-4 per cent below its all-time high touched in August 2024. In contrast, the benchmark BSE Sensex remains nearly 10-11 per cent off its peak, highlighting the relative strength in PSU counters. On the contrary, a large number of PSU stocks are still trading well below their respective 52-week highs, reflecting the uneven nature of the recovery.

PSU Stocks Off 52-Week Highs

Company Name	Latest Market Cap. (₹ Cr.)	Current Price (₹)	52-Week High Price (₹)	Correction (%)
Mahanagar Telephone Nigam Ltd.	1,966.86	31.30	58.00	-46.03
KIOCL Ltd.	24,358.31	400.00	634.35	-36.94
Indian Railway Catering & Tourism Corp. Ltd.	43,600.56	545.15	820.20	-33.53
Ircon International Ltd.	14,141.60	150.45	225.70	-33.34
Cochin Shipyard Ltd.	44,816.75	1,699.50	2,547.25	-33.28
National Fertilizers Ltd.	3,731.34	76.11	112.11	-32.11
Rail Vikas Nigam Ltd.	63,799.52	305.95	448.00	-31.71
Rites Ltd.	10,487.25	218.15	316.15	-31.00
NBCC (India) Ltd.	24,885.51	92.46	130.60	-29.20
Hindustan Copper Ltd.	52,367.69	542.00	759.20	-28.61

This divergence has left investors at a crossroads. Does the correction offer an attractive entry point at relatively lower valuations? Or does the recent volatility raise questions about the sustainability of the PSU rally and its long-term growth potential? The answer lies in understanding the structural drivers. First, the government's policy direction remains supportive. Capital expenditure continues to be a central pillar of economic strategy. This directly benefits PSUs in infrastructure, engineering, and construction.

Second, balance sheets have improved significantly. Public sector banks are in a far better position compared to a decade ago. Lower NPAs, better capital adequacy, and stronger governance frameworks have enhanced investor confidence. Third, many PSUs offer a combination of growth and income. Attractive dividend yields provide downside support, while earnings growth offers upside potential. Fourth, valuation discipline has returned after the correction.

While not as cheap as they once were, many PSU stocks are now trading at levels that are more aligned with their fundamentals. This positive backdrop keeps the long-term outlook for PSUs firmly optimistic. As India enters a phase of sustained economic expansion, these enterprises are well-positioned to capitalise on multiple structural opportunities. While near-term volatility cannot be ruled out, the broader trajectory suggests that PSUs are gradually transitioning from cyclical trades to more enduring plays on India's growth story.

Final Thoughts

The PSU story is ultimately about transformation. From being seen as inefficient and policy-bound entities, many PSUs have evolved into competitive, profit-generating enterprises. This transformation is not uniform across the board, but the direction is clear. For investors, the opportunity lies in identifying companies where fundamentals align with the broader structural story. This calls for a selective approach rather than a broad-based bet on the entire PSU space. Companies with strong order visibility, improving return ratios, and clear strategic positioning within key sectors are more likely to deliver sustainable returns. The focus should be on quality within the theme, not just the theme itself. As India continues its growth journey, PSUs are unlikely to fade into the background. If anything, their role is set to expand. And that makes them hard to ignore.

DSIJ's Annual Tribute

Recognizing the vital role PSUs play in shaping India's strategic and economic growth, we at Dalal Street Investment Journal (DSIJ) take pride in celebrating their achievements each year. With this special feature dedicated to PSUs, we are delighted to present our annual tribute to the best-performing public sector enterprises across the country.

Through meticulous analysis of multiple parameters, we have identified the PSUs that truly stand out. We believe these recognitions go beyond numbers; they highlight resilience, vision, and a commitment to long-term value creation. Read on to discover the methodology behind our rankings and meet the PSUs that have earned their place in the spotlight.

PSU Ranking Methodology

Maharatna/Navratna/Miniratna: The basic parameters to assess the winning companies are balance sheet size, net sales, and overall profitability. These parameters are used to evaluate the companies in terms of size. To calculate the final rank, equal weightage has been given to balance sheet size, net profit, operating profit, and net sales, with 25 per cent assigned to each. The composite ranking provides the basis for deciding the winner.

For the selection of the most efficient companies, we evaluated their operational efficiency. Hence, we have considered parameters such as cost of employees as against sales, working capital efficiency, and leverage ratio. These parameters reflect the level of efficiency the companies are delivering. Equal weightage has been given to all three parameters to arrive at the final ranking.

For the selection of the fastest-growing companies, the emphasis is on the growth achieved during the recent three years compared to peers. For this, we consider growth in sales, net profit, and operating profit. To incorporate operational performance relative to the capital invested, we also evaluate return on net worth and return on capital employed. The compounded annual growth over the last three years provides a true picture of the company in terms of its overall growth. All individual parameters are given equal weightage to calculate the final rank.

Banks: Banks are ranked on comprehensive financial parameters. The financial performances are grouped in three major categories namely size, growth, and efficiency. Again, these major categories are subdivided and test various critical parameters to judge the performance of PSU banks for the fiscal year.

While considering size, we subdivided it into size of total assets of bank, total income, operating profit, and net profit. For growth, we have considered CAGR in net interest income, and balance sheet size of last 2 years ending FY25. For most efficient category, we have considered business per employee, profit per employee and Return on Asset (RoA) for FY25. All the individual parameters are given appropriate weightage to arrive at final ranking.

Insurance: In insurance, we are keen to see that the growth in premium is balanced with the growth in claims. We also rank the companies to ensure that the best balance sheet is recognized, with liabilities sufficiently covered by reserves and balances.

National Fertilizers Limited: Growth Engines Take the Lead

Dr. U. Saravanan
Chairman & Managing Director
National Fertilizers Limited

Which business segment is expected to drive growth going forward?

The segment that is expected to drive the growth going forward, apart from Urea and P&K fertilizers, are sale of the following products:

- Agro Chemicals
- Non-Subsidised Products like PDM, Seaweed, Neem Oil, Neem Cake, etc. and Water-Soluble Fertilizers
- Industrial Products, Bentonite Sulphur, Bio Fertilizers, etc.

How has been the financial performance in the nine months?

During the nine months ended December 2025, total revenue increased to ₹17,208.54 crores from ₹15,408.13 crores in the corresponding period of the previous year.

The company also reported a profit before tax of ₹76.01 crores, compared to a loss of ₹25.80 crores in the same period last year. Accordingly, profitability has improved by ₹101.81 crores during the nine-month period.

How conflict in Middle East is impacting your overall industry in general and your business in specific?

- The nitrogenous fertilizer industry, including NFL, is closely linked to natural gas, and a significant portion of India's RLNG imports originate from the Middle East. The ongoing geopolitical tensions in the region have therefore impacted the industry through some initial restrictions in gas supply to fertilizer companies. However, the GoI responded swiftly, coordinating with gas suppliers to ensure continuity of supplies through alternate sourcing and spot procurement. As a result, the situation has stabilised, and currently there is no limitation regarding availability of natural gas for fertilizer production.
- Further, disruption occurred on the supply of raw materials for P and K fertilizers production, i.e., import of Ammonia, Phosphoric Acid, Rock Phosphate, Sulphur, etc., that resulted in reduced domestic production of DAP, SSP and NPKS. The supply of finished bulk fertilizers also has got hit.
- International availability of imported fertilizers drastically reduced, resulting into lesser availability at high prices.
- The current geo-political situation has also led to increase in the ocean freight rates, leading to overall surge in prices.
- The primary impact for NFL is on input costs, and with higher gas prices, the input costs increase, which results in constraints in working capital.
- Overall, while the geopolitical situation has introduced some cost pressures, NFL is ensuring stable operations and uninterrupted fertilizer supply to farmers.

When can core manufactured fertilizer segment return to healthy profitability?

Continuing from the impact of the Middle East situation, while the availability of natural gas has been largely stabilised due to timely intervention by GoI and coordinated efforts, the elevated price environment remains a key factor influencing profitability.

The core manufactured fertilizer segment is sensitive to energy costs, and the recent volatility has led to some pressure on margins. However, with supply chains now largely normalised, the focus shifts to stabilisation of gas prices and alignment of subsidy support with input costs.

We expect a gradual and calibrated improvement in profitability as global energy markets ease and pricing stabilises. Backed by our emphasis on operational efficiency, energy conservation, and optimal capacity utilisation, we are confident that the segment should return to healthier profitability levels over the next few months, provided there are no further major geopolitical disruptions.

Any new initiative of the company for empowering the farming community?

We are continuously expanding our product portfolio and strengthening our market presence. In a new initiative, the company has launched NFL Direct Sales Centres (NDSCs) under the banner 'Kisan Dhan – Seedhe Kisan Tak' across the country, providing farmers with access to quality agri-inputs under one roof. Presently, the company has NDSCs at 30 locations in various states. Under the theme 'Kisan Dhan: Seedhe Kisan Tak', these centres will help reduce dependency on intermediaries, ensure transparency in fertilizer distribution, and ensure timely availability of quality fertilizers to farmers at Government-notified prices.

How has the JV, RFCL, performed this year and what is the outlook ahead?

- NFL is holding a 26 per cent equity stake in RFCL.
- RFCL's profitability for the nine months ended December 2025 stood at ₹33.38 crores, compared to ₹270.22 crores in the corresponding period of the previous year, reflecting a significant decline. This was primarily due to an unplanned plant shutdown between April and September 2025, which resulted in a substantial reduction in production of approximately 3 Lakh MT and adversely impacted overall margins.
- Further, it is important to note that RFCL has now largely stabilised its operations and is consistently achieving improved capacity utilisation. As operational efficiencies improve further and energy consumption norms are optimised, we expect its financial performance to strengthen.
- Going forward, RFCL is expected to contribute more steadily, and that JV profitability will see a gradual improvement during the ongoing financial year.

India's Best Public Sector Undertakings

ROLL OF HONOUR

Indian Oil Corporation Ltd.

Maharatna of the Year - Manufacturing

Indian Oil Corporation Ltd is India's flagship national oil company and one of the largest integrated energy enterprises in the country. Established in 1959 and headquartered in New Delhi, the company operates across the entire hydrocarbon value chain, including refining, pipeline transportation, marketing of petroleum products, petrochemicals, and exploration and production of oil and gas. The company has built a strong nationwide presence with an extensive network of fuel stations, LPG distribution under the Indane brand, and a wide pipeline infrastructure that supports efficient energy distribution across the country. It also has a significant share in India's petroleum products market and serves millions of customers through diverse energy offerings. Indian Oil has expanded its footprint internationally with subsidiaries in regions such as Sri Lanka, Mauritius, and the Middle East, while continuously exploring new energy markets. In line with evolving energy needs, the company is investing in cleaner and alternative energy solutions including biofuels, hydrogen, and renewable energy. With its scale, integration, and strategic focus, Indian Oil continues to play a central role in India's energy security and transition.

Shri A S Sahney
Chairman
Indian Oil Corporation Ltd.

India's Best Public Sector Undertakings

ROLL OF HONOUR

Bharat Petroleum Corporation Ltd.

Fastest Growing Maharatna of the Year - Manufacturing

Bharat Petroleum Corporation Ltd is a leading public sector enterprise engaged in the refining, marketing, and distribution of petroleum products in India. Established in 1976 and headquartered in Mumbai, the company operates under the Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas and is one of the country's key downstream oil companies. BPCL operates major refineries in Mumbai, Kochi, and Bina, with a strong focus on producing high-quality fuels that meet evolving environmental standards. The company has built an extensive nationwide distribution network comprising fuel retail outlets, LPG distribution under the Bharatgas brand, aviation fuel services, and industrial supply channels. The company has also expanded into upstream exploration and production through strategic investments and partnerships. In line with India's energy transition, BPCL is actively investing in renewable energy, biofuels, compressed biogas, and electric mobility infrastructure. With a strong brand presence, integrated operations, and customer-focused approach, BPCL continues to play a significant role in India's energy ecosystem while aligning its strategy with sustainability and future energy needs.

Shri Sanjay Khanna
Chairman & Managing Director and Director (Refineries)
Bharat Petroleum Corporation Ltd.

India's Best Public Sector Undertakings

India’s Best Public Sector Undertakings

ROLL OF HONOUR

NTPC Ltd.

Most Efficient and Profitable Maharatna of the Year - Manufacturing

Shri Gurdeep Singh
Chairman & Managing Director
NTPC Ltd.

NTPC Ltd is India’s largest integrated power utility and a central public sector enterprise under the Ministry of Power. Incorporated in 1975 and headquartered in New Delhi, the company is primarily engaged in the generation and sale of electricity to state utilities and other beneficiaries across the country. NTPC has a diversified power generation portfolio that includes coal-based, gas-based, hydroelectric, solar, and wind energy projects. It contributes a significant share to India’s total power generation and is known for its operational efficiency and high plant load factors. The company is actively expanding its renewable energy capacity and has set ambitious targets in solar and wind power. It is also exploring emerging areas such as green hydrogen, energy storage, and electric vehicle charging infrastructure. The company aims to become a 149 GW capacity player with a diversified fuel mix and achieve power generation of over 650 BU by 2032. With its scale, strong execution capabilities, and focus on sustainability, NTPC continues to play a crucial role in ensuring reliable power supply while supporting India’s transition toward a cleaner energy mix.

ROLL OF HONOUR

Oil & Natural Gas Corporation Ltd.

Maharatna of the Year - Non-Manufacturing

Shri Arun Kumar Singh
Chairman & CEO
Oil & Natural Gas Corporation Ltd.

Oil & Natural Gas Corporation Ltd is India’s largest crude oil and natural gas exploration and production company. Established in 1956 and headquartered in New Delhi, ONGC is a central public sector enterprise under the Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas and plays a vital role in India’s energy security. The company is engaged in the exploration, development, and production of hydrocarbons, with operations spanning both onshore and offshore fields across India. ONGC contributes a significant share of the country’s domestic crude oil and natural gas output. Through its subsidiary ONGC Videsh Ltd, the company has established a global footprint with exploration and production assets in multiple countries. ONGC is also involved in related activities such as refining, petrochemicals, and value-added energy products through its group companies. In line with changing energy dynamics, the company is exploring opportunities in renewable energy, carbon capture, and alternative fuels. With its extensive resource base and technical expertise, ONGC remains a cornerstone of India’s upstream energy sector.

ROLL OF HONOUR

GAIL (India) Limited

GAIL (India) Ltd.

Fastest Growing Maharatna of the Year - Non-Manufacturing

GAIL (India) Ltd is India's leading natural gas company and a central public sector enterprise under the Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas. Incorporated in 1984, the company is primarily engaged in natural gas transmission, marketing, and processing. GAIL owns and operates one of the largest natural gas pipeline networks in India, enabling the transportation of gas across key industrial and consumption centres. The company is also involved in the marketing of natural gas, production of liquefied petroleum gas, petrochemicals, and city gas distribution through joint ventures. It has expanded its presence in the liquefied natural gas segment through long-term sourcing arrangements and infrastructure development. GAIL is also investing in renewable energy, biofuels, and green hydrogen to align with India's energy transition goals. With its integrated operations and strong infrastructure base, GAIL plays a critical role in promoting the use of cleaner fuels and supporting the growth of the gas-based economy in India.

Shri Deepak Gupta
Chairman & Managing Director and Director (Projects)
GAIL (India) Ltd.

India's Best Public Sector Undertakings

ROLL OF HONOUR

ऑयल इंडिया
OIL INDIA

Oil India Ltd.

Most Efficient and Profitable Maharatna of the Year - Non-Manufacturing

Oil India Ltd is a prominent public sector company engaged in the exploration, development, and production of crude oil and natural gas. Established in 1959, the company operates under the Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas. The company has a strong presence in onshore oil and gas fields, particularly in the northeastern region of India, and contributes significantly to domestic hydrocarbon production. Oil India is also involved in transportation of crude oil and production of liquefied petroleum gas. In addition to its domestic operations, the company has expanded internationally through participation in exploration and production projects in several countries. It has also diversified into renewable energy, including solar and wind power initiatives. With its focus on operational efficiency, resource optimization, and diversification, Oil India continues to strengthen its position as a key contributor to India's upstream energy sector while adapting to the evolving global energy landscape.

Dr. Ranjit Rath
Chairman & Managing Director
Oil India Ltd.

India's Best Public Sector Undertakings

India's Best Public Sector Undertakings

ROLL OF HONOUR

सेल SAIL

Steel Authority of India Ltd.

Wealth Creators - Maharatna

Steel Authority of India Ltd is one of India's largest steel-producing companies and a public sector enterprise under the Ministry of Steel. Incorporated in 1973, the company is engaged in the production and sale of a wide range of steel products. SAIL operates several integrated steel plants and special steel units located across the country, supported by captive iron ore and coal mines. Its product portfolio includes flat and long steel products, rails, structural steel, and specialty steels catering to sectors such as infrastructure, construction, railways, defence, and engineering. The company has undertaken modernization and expansion initiatives to enhance capacity, improve efficiency, and produce value-added steel products. It is also focusing on sustainability by adopting energy-efficient technologies and reducing carbon emissions. With its strong manufacturing base, integrated operations, and strategic importance to core industries, SAIL continues to play a crucial role in supporting India's infrastructure development and industrial growth.

Shri Krishna Kumar Singh
Director (Personnel)
Add. Charge of CMD
Steel Authority Of India Ltd.

India's Best Public Sector Undertakings

ROLL OF HONOUR

एन एफ एल
NFL
A Navratna Company

National Fertilizers Ltd.

Navratna of the Year - Manufacturing

National Fertilizers Ltd is a central public sector undertaking engaged in the production and marketing of fertilizers and other agricultural inputs. Incorporated in 1974 and headquartered in Noida, the company operates under the Ministry of Chemicals and Fertilizers. NFL is one of the leading producers of urea in India, with multiple manufacturing units across the country. Its product portfolio includes neem-coated urea, bio-fertilizers, and industrial chemicals such as ammonia and nitric acid. The company markets its products under the Kisan brand, serving a large base of farmers across India. The company plays a vital role in supporting agricultural productivity by ensuring the timely availability of fertilizers. It has also taken initiatives to promote balanced nutrient usage and sustainable farming practices. With its strong distribution network, focus on operational efficiency, and commitment to the agricultural sector, National Fertilizers continues to contribute significantly to India's food security and rural economy.

Dr. U. Saravanan
Chairman & Managing Director
National Fertilizers Ltd.

India's Best Public Sector Undertakings

ROLL OF HONOUR

Rail Vikas Nigam Ltd.

Fastest Growing Navratna of the Year - Manufacturing

Rail Vikas Nigam Ltd is a public sector enterprise under the Ministry of Railways, primarily engaged in the development and implementation of rail infrastructure projects across India. Incorporated in 2003, the company was established to bridge critical infrastructure gaps in the railway sector. RVNL undertakes project development activities including doubling of railway lines, gauge conversion, electrification, construction of bridges, workshops, and other railway infrastructure. It executes projects on a turnkey basis and works closely with Indian Railways and other government agencies. The company has also expanded into metro rail, highways, and international projects, leveraging its expertise in infrastructure development. RVNL focuses on timely execution, cost efficiency, and quality delivery of projects. With its strong order book and execution capabilities, the company plays a key role in enhancing railway capacity, improving connectivity, and supporting India's broader infrastructure development goals.

Shri Saleem Ahmad
Chairman & Managing Director
Rail Vikas Nigam Ltd.

India's Best Public Sector Undertakings

ROLL OF HONOUR

Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Ltd.

Most Efficient Navratna of the Year - Manufacturing

Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Ltd is a leading public sector shipyard under the Ministry of Defence, specializing in the construction of warships and submarines for the Indian Navy. Incorporated in 1934, the company is one of India's premier defence shipbuilding organizations. The company has built a wide range of naval vessels including destroyers, frigates, and submarines, and has played a crucial role in strengthening India's maritime defence capabilities. It also undertakes repair and refit services for naval and commercial vessels. Mazagon Dock has developed strong in-house capabilities in design, engineering, and project management, enabling it to execute complex defence projects. The company is also exploring export opportunities and expanding its capabilities in line with the government?s focus on self-reliance in defence production. With its strong order book and technological expertise, Mazagon Dock continues to be a key contributor to India's naval modernization and defence manufacturing ecosystem.

Captain Jagmohan IN (Retd.)
Chairman & Managing Director
Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Ltd.

India's Best Public Sector Undertakings

ROLL OF HONOUR

Rites Ltd.

Navratna of the Year - Non-Manufacturing

RITES Ltd is a leading engineering consultancy company specializing in transport infrastructure, operating under the Ministry of Railways. Incorporated in 1974, the company provides consultancy services across railways, highways, ports, airports, and urban transport. The company offers a wide range of services including project planning, design, engineering, procurement, construction supervision, and quality assurance. RITES has executed projects in India as well as in multiple countries across Asia, Africa, and Latin America. In addition to consultancy, the company is also engaged in the export of rolling stock and railway equipment. It has developed expertise in transport infrastructure and project management, supported by a strong technical workforce. With its diversified service portfolio and global presence, RITES continues to play a significant role in infrastructure development while expanding its footprint in international markets.

Shri Rahul Mithal
Chairman & Managing Director
Rites Ltd.

ROLL OF HONOUR

SJVN Ltd.

Fastest Growing Navratna of the Year - Non-Manufacturing

SJVN Ltd is a public sector company engaged in power generation, primarily focused on hydroelectric projects, and operates under the Ministry of Power. Incorporated in 1988 and headquartered in Shimla, the company was initially formed as a joint venture between the Government of India and the Government of Himachal Pradesh. The company develops, operates, and maintains hydroelectric power projects and has diversified into thermal, solar, and wind energy. SJVN is expanding its renewable energy portfolio with a focus on sustainable and clean power generation. It has also ventured into international markets, undertaking hydroelectric projects in countries such as Nepal and Bhutan. The company is working toward increasing its installed capacity through a mix of conventional and renewable energy projects. With its focus on sustainability, project execution, and capacity expansion, SJVN continues to contribute to India’s power sector while aligning with the country’s clean energy transition goals.

Shri Bhupender Gupta
Chairman & Managing Director
SJVN Ltd.

ROLL OF HONOUR

NBCC (India) Ltd.

Most Efficient and Profitable Navratna of the Year - Non-Manufacturing

NBCC (India) Ltd is a leading public sector enterprise engaged in project management consultancy, engineering procurement and construction, and real estate development. Incorporated in 1960, the company operates under the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs. NBCC has established itself as a key executor of large-scale government redevelopment projects, including the transformation of government colonies, institutional buildings, and urban infrastructure. The company follows an asset-light business model in its consultancy segment, which contributes significantly to its profitability and ensures efficient capital utilization. It has been actively involved in flagship initiatives such as smart cities, urban redevelopment, and infrastructure modernization projects across India. NBCC has also expanded its international footprint with projects in regions such as Africa and the Middle East. Its diversified order book, strong execution capabilities, and focus on timely delivery provide revenue visibility. With a strategic role in urban transformation and infrastructure development, NBCC continues to be a significant contributor to India's real estate and construction ecosystem.

Dr. K. P. Mahadevaswamy
Chairman & Managing Director
NBCC (India) Ltd.

India's Best Public Sector Undertakings

ROLL OF HONOUR

National Aluminium Company Ltd.

Wealth Creators - Navratna

National Aluminium Company Ltd is a Navratna public sector enterprise and one of India's leading integrated aluminium producers. Incorporated in 1981 and headquartered in Bhubaneswar, the company operates under the Ministry of Mines. NALCO is engaged in the entire value chain of aluminium production, including bauxite mining, alumina refining, aluminium smelting, and power generation. The company operates one of Asia?s largest integrated aluminium complexes, supported by captive bauxite mines and dedicated power plants that ensure cost efficiency and operational stability. Its product portfolio includes alumina, aluminium metal, billets, wire rods, and rolled products catering to both domestic and international markets. NALCO exports a substantial portion of its output and has built a strong global presence over the years. It is also focusing on sustainability through energy efficiency initiatives and increased use of renewable power. With its integrated operations, strong resource base, and cost competitiveness, NALCO remains a key player in India's non-ferrous metals sector.

Shri Brijendra Pratap Singh
Chairman & Managing Director
National Aluminium Company Ltd.

India's Best Public Sector Undertakings

India's Best Public Sector Undertakings

ROLL OF HONOUR

MIDHANI
Mishra Dhatu Nigam Limited
(MIDHANI)

Mishra Dhatu Nigam Ltd.

Miniratna of the Year - Manufacturing

Mishra Dhatu Nigam Ltd is a specialized public sector enterprise engaged in the manufacturing of superalloys and special metals. Established in 1973 and headquartered in Hyderabad, the company operates under the Ministry of Defence. MIDHANI plays a strategic role in supplying high-performance materials used in critical sectors such as defence, aerospace, nuclear, and space. The company?s product portfolio includes superalloys, titanium alloys, special steels, and other advanced materials designed for high-temperature and high-stress applications. It has developed strong metallurgical capabilities and manufacturing expertise, enabling it to cater to complex and mission-critical requirements. MIDHANI maintains close associations with key organizations such as ISRO, DRDO, and HAL, supporting various national programs. The company continues to invest in research and development to enhance its product offerings and expand into new applications. With its niche positioning and technological strengths, MIDHANI remains an important contributor to India's strategic and high-technology manufacturing ecosystem.

Dr. S. V. S. Narayana Murty
Chairman & Managing Director
Mishra Dhatu Nigam Ltd.

India's Best Public Sector Undertakings

ROLL OF HONOUR

बी ई एम एल
BEML
Beyond Possibilities

BEML Ltd.

Fastest Growing Miniratna of the Year - Manufacturing

BEML Ltd is a diversified public sector enterprise engaged in manufacturing equipment for defence, mining, construction, and rail sectors. Established in 1964, the company operates under the Ministry of Defence. BEML has developed a strong presence in producing a wide range of heavy equipment and engineering solutions for core industries. Its product portfolio includes earthmoving equipment, mining machinery, defence vehicles, and metro and rail coaches. The company has contributed significantly to infrastructure development by supplying equipment to sectors such as coal, steel, power, and construction. It is also a key supplier of rolling stock for metro rail projects in various Indian cities. BEML focuses on indigenization and technological development, aligning with the government?s emphasis on self-reliance in manufacturing. With its diversified operations, strong manufacturing capabilities, and focus on innovation, BEML continues to support India's infrastructure growth and defence preparedness.

Shri Shantanu Roy
Chairman & Managing Director
BEML Ltd.

India's Best Public Sector Undertakings

ROLL OF HONOUR

बामर लॉरी एण्ड कं. लिमिटेड (भारत सरकार का एक प्रतिष्ठान)
Balmer Lawrie & Co. Ltd. (A Government of India Enterprise)
SINCE 1867

Balmer Lawrie & Company Ltd.

Most Efficient and Profitable Miniratna of the Year - Manufacturing

Balmer Lawrie & Company Ltd is a diversified public sector enterprise operating under the Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas. Established in 1867, the company has evolved into a multi-business conglomerate with a presence across manufacturing and services. Its key business segments include industrial packaging, logistics services, travel and vacation services, greases and lubricants, and refinery and oil field services. The company has built a strong reputation for quality, reliability, and customer-centric operations across its diversified portfolio. Balmer Lawrie also operates in niche areas such as cold chain logistics and specialty chemicals, catering to both industrial and consumer markets. It has expanded its footprint through a mix of domestic operations and selective international presence. With its diversified business model, stable performance, and focus on innovation, Balmer Lawrie continues to maintain a resilient position across multiple sectors.

Shri Adhip Nath Palchaudhuri
Chairman & Managing Director and Director (Service Businesses)
Balmer Lawrie & Company Ltd.

India's Best Public Sector Undertakings

ROLL OF HONOUR

भारत पर्यटन विकास निगम लि.
India Tourism Development Corporation Ltd.
(भारत सरकार का उपक्रम)
(A Government of India Undertaking)

India Tourism Development Corp. Ltd.

Miniratna of the Year - Non-Manufacturing

India Tourism Development Corporation Ltd is a public sector enterprise engaged in the development and promotion of tourism infrastructure in India. Incorporated in 1966, the company operates under the Ministry of Tourism and plays an important role in supporting the country's hospitality sector. ITDC owns and operates hotels under the Ashok Group brand, along with restaurants, transport services, and duty-free shops. It also provides consultancy and project management services for tourism and hospitality projects across the country. The company has been associated with organizing and supporting major national and international events, contributing to the promotion of India as a global tourist destination. ITDC focuses on delivering quality hospitality services while preserving cultural heritage and enhancing tourist experiences. With its established brand presence, diversified operations, and strategic role in tourism development, ITDC continues to contribute to the growth and visibility of India's tourism industry.

Mugdha Sinha
Managing Director
India Tourism Development Corporation Ltd.

India's Best Public Sector Undertakings

India's Best Public Sector Undertakings

ROLL OF HONOUR

MSTC LIMITED (A GOVT. OF INDIA ENTERPRISE)

MSTC Ltd.

Fastest Growing, Most Efficient & Profitable Miniratna of the Year - Non-Manufacturing

Shri Manobendra Ghoshal
Chairman & Managing Director
MSTC Ltd.

MSTC Ltd is a government-owned enterprise engaged in e-commerce services, trading, and recycling operations. Incorporated in 1964, the company operates under the Ministry of Steel. Over the years, MSTC has transformed itself from a traditional trading company into a technology-driven digital platform. The company provides e-auction and e-procurement services to government departments, public sector undertakings, and private sector clients. It plays a key role in enabling transparent and efficient disposal of scrap, minerals, and other assets through its digital platforms. MSTC is also actively involved in recycling initiatives, including vehicle scrapping through its subsidiary, supporting environmental sustainability and circular economy practices. Its platforms handle large transaction volumes across multiple sectors. With its focus on digital transformation, operational efficiency, and diversified service offerings, MSTC continues to strengthen its position in India's e-commerce and resource management space.

India's Best Public Sector Undertakings

ROLL OF HONOUR

HINDUSTAN COPPER LIMITED
(A Govt. of India Enterprise)
The Copper Miner to the Nation

Hindustan Copper Ltd.

Wealth Creators - Miniratna

Shri Sanjiv Kumar Singh
Chairman & Managing Director
Hindustan Copper Ltd.

Hindustan Copper Ltd is a public sector enterprise engaged in copper mining and production, operating under the Ministry of Mines. Incorporated in 1967, the company is India's only vertically integrated copper producer. The company is involved in the complete value chain of copper production, including mining, beneficiation, smelting, refining, and casting of refined copper metal. It operates several mining units across India and holds significant copper ore reserves. Hindustan Copper supplies copper products to key industries such as power, infrastructure, telecommunications, and manufacturing. The company is undertaking expansion and modernization initiatives to enhance production capacity and improve operational efficiency. With its integrated operations, resource base, and strategic importance in the non-ferrous metals sector, Hindustan Copper continues to play a vital role in supporting India's industrial and infrastructure development.

India's Best Public Sector Undertakings

ROLL OF HONOUR

Bank of Maharashtra

Best Bank of the Year

Bank of Maharashtra is a public sector bank established in 1935 and headquartered in Pune. It operates under the ownership of the Government of India and provides a comprehensive range of banking and financial services. The bank serves retail, corporate, and MSME customers through a wide network of branches and digital banking platforms. Its offerings include deposits, loans, treasury operations, and digital payment solutions. The bank has a strong presence in western India and has been steadily expanding its national footprint. In recent years, Bank of Maharashtra has focused on improving asset quality, strengthening its balance sheet, and enhancing profitability. It has also emphasized lending to priority sectors such as agriculture, MSMEs, and retail borrowers. With its focus on operational efficiency, digital transformation, and customer-centric approach, the bank continues to strengthen its position in India's competitive banking landscape.

Shri Nidhu Saxena
Managing Director & CEO
Bank of Maharashtra

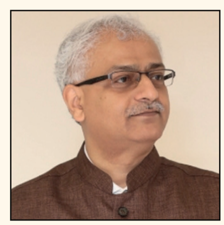
India's Best Public Sector Undertakings

ROLL OF HONOUR

General Insurance Corporation of India

Best Insurance Company of the Year

General Insurance Corporation of India is the country's sole reinsurance company and a public sector enterprise under the Ministry of Finance. Incorporated in 1972, the company plays a critical role in supporting the insurance ecosystem. GIC Re provides reinsurance support to domestic insurers and also operates in international markets, offering risk solutions across diverse segments. Its portfolio spans property, marine, aviation, agriculture, and health reinsurance, among others. The company has established a global presence with branches and subsidiaries in several countries, making it a significant participant in the international reinsurance market. It focuses on prudent underwriting, risk diversification, and strengthening its global portfolio. With its strong market position, international reach, and expertise in risk management, GIC Re continues to play a vital role in enhancing the stability and resilience of the insurance sector in India and globally.



Shri Hitesh Joshi
Executive Director - Additional Charge of CMD
General Insurance Corporation of India

India's Best Public Sector Undertakings

Banking

Bank of Baroda

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25
Deposits	13,26,957.84	12,03,687.79	10,45,938.56	9,66,996.93	9,45,984.43
Advances	10,65,781.72	9,40,998.27	7,77,155.18	7,06,300.51	6,90,120.73
Net Interest Income	44,721.53	41,356.01	32,621.34	28,809.02	27,451.63
Other Income	14,495.37	10,025.84	11,483.95	12,364.44	10,317.00
Prov. & Cont.	13,176.44	12,753.92	15,116.57	19,801.00	19,145.24
Net Profit	17,788.78	14,109.62	7,272.28	828.95	546.19

Bank of Maharashtra

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25
Deposits	2,70,747.17	2,34,082.68	2,02,294.29	1,74,006.00	1,50,066.40
Advances	2,00,239.88	1,71,220.67	1,31,170.44	1,02,405.00	86,872.00
Net Interest Income	9,821.85	7,740.78	6,044.40	4,898.00	4,278.00
Other Income	2,997.87	2,280.27	2,652.48	2,625.00	1,649.00
Prov. & Cont.	3,950.31	3,497.18	3,696.33	3,408.00	2,457.00
Net Profit	4,055.03	2,602.03	1,151.54	550.00	389.00

Central Bank of India

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25
Deposits	3,85,011.32	3,59,296.47	3,42,691.94	3,29,972.95	3,13,763.16
Advances	2,43,406.28	2,02,984.31	1,68,173.50	1,56,579.00	1,51,101.00
Net Interest Income	12,896.32	11,686.79	9,486.77	8,245.00	7,628.85
Other Income	4,711.28	4,083.71	2,968.48	3,168.00	3,636.82
Prov. & Cont.	4,813.62	5,301.56	4,152.32	5,518.00	5,465.50
Net Profit	2,549.06	1,582.20	1,044.83	-888.00	-1,121.35

Indian Overseas Bank

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25
Deposits	2,85,905.38	2,60,883.29	2,62,158.92	2,40,288.00	2,22,952.00
Advances	2,13,318.81	1,78,052.57	1,44,243.52	1,27,721.00	1,21,333.00
Net Interest Income	9,829.41	8,254.89	6,311.14	5,899.00	5,303.00
Other Income	5,656.26	4,108.75	4,903.02	5,559.00	3,306.00
Prov. & Cont.	4,108.15	3,843.39	4,053.37	5,065.00	12,007.00
Net Profit	2,655.61	2,098.79	1,709.54	831.00	-8,527.00

Punjab National Bank

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25
Deposits	13,69,712.81	12,81,163.10	11,46,218.45	11,06,332.00	7,03,846.00
Advances	9,34,430.59	8,30,833.98	7,28,185.67	6,74,230.00	4,71,828.00
Net Interest Income	40,083.07	34,491.63	28,694.45	30,477.00	17,438.00
Other Income	13,383.54	12,142.53	12,319.96	11,922.31	9,274.00
Prov. & Cont.	16,686.19	20,021.55	17,304.86	20,136.56	14,403.00
Net Profit	8,244.62	2,507.20	3,456.96	2,022.00	336.00

Union Bank of India

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25
Deposits	12,21,528.37	11,17,716.32	10,32,392.63	9,23,805.00	4,50,668.00
Advances	8,70,776.09	7,61,845.46	6,61,004.66	5,90,983.00	3,15,049.00
Net Interest Income	36,570.40	32,765.34	27,786.46	24,688.00	11,437.00
Other Income	16,080.19	14,633.15	12,524.82	11,337.00	5,261.00
Prov. & Cont.	14,562.32	17,033.89	16,641.11	16,353.00	12,080.00
Net Profit	13,648.31	8,433.27	5,232.10	2,906.00	-2,898.00

Bank of India

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25
Deposits	7,37,920.21	6,69,586.00	6,27,895.96	6,27,113.56	5,55,505.00
Advances	5,63,144.67	4,85,899.64	4,20,841.79	3,65,686.52	3,68,883.00
Net Interest Income	23,052.92	20,274.90	14,062.10	14,269.84	15,257.00
Other Income	6,094.85	7,099.89	7,878.73	7,441.49	6,713.00
Prov. & Cont.	7,750.69	9,369.68	6,583.75	8,711.92	14,476.00
Net Profit	6,317.92	4,022.94	3,404.70	2,160.30	-2,957.00

Canara Bank

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25
Deposits	13,12,366.61	11,79,218.61	10,86,409.25	10,10,874.58	6,25,351.00
Advances	9,31,612.83	8,30,672.55	7,03,601.82	6,39,048.99	4,32,175.00
Net Interest Income	36,565.94	31,435.29	26,383.99	24,062.00	13,124.00
Other Income	18,966.44	18,762.20	16,496.90	15,285.00	7,813.00
Prov. & Cont.	14,858.26	17,112.24	17,410.56	17,451.00	11,595.72
Net Profit	14,554.33	10,603.77	5,678.42	2,558.00	-2,235.72

Indian Bank

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25
Deposits	6,88,000.00	6,21,165.76	5,93,617.81	5,38,071.00	2,60,226.00
Advances	5,14,889.07	4,49,296.73	3,89,186.06	3,64,010.00	1,97,887.00
Net Interest Income	23,273.29	20,225.46	16,727.95	15,666.00	7,606.00
Other Income	7,866.72	7,143.06	6,915.45	5,650.19	3,312.00
Prov. & Cont.	8,776.61	9,988.92	8,772.08	8,391.00	5,744.00
Net Profit	8,062.94	5,281.70	3,944.82	3,005.00	753.00

Punjab & Sind Bank

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25
Deposits	1,19,409.55	1,09,665.49	1,02,137.01	96,108.18	89,668.00
Advances	82,736.38	76,819.43	63,626.56	60,942.00	58,412.00
Net Interest Income	2,841.04	2,973.38	2,651.31	2,262.00	2,058.00
Other Income	1,221.47	939.96	959.38	903.00	897.00
Prov. & Cont.	535.52	136.91	291.04	3,504.00	2,088.00
Net Profit	595.42	1,313.03	1,039.05	-2,733.00	-991.00

Banking

UCO Bank

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25
Deposits	2,63,129.77	2,49,337.74	2,24,072.90	2,05,919.00	1,93,203.44
Advances	1,82,021.87	1,55,870.18	1,22,784.41	1,11,355.00	1,01,174.00
Net Interest Income	8,100.78	7,343.13	6,472.95	5,480.00	5,092.27
Other Income	3,265.53	2,508.46	3,100.81	3,424.18	2,871.21
Prov. & Cont.	2,922.50	2,478.33	3,867.67	3,982.03	7,272.43
Net Profit	1,653.74	1,862.34	929.77	167.00	-2,436.83

State Bank of India

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25
Deposits	49,16,077.00	44,23,777.77	40,51,534.00	36,81,277.00	32,41,621.00
Advances	37,03,971.00	31,99,269.29	27,33,967.00	24,49,497.79	23,25,290.00
Net Interest Income	1,59,876.00	1,44,840.50	1,20,707.00	1,10,710.00	98,085.00
Other Income	51,682.00	36,615.59	40,564.00	43,496.37	45,221.00
Prov. & Cont.	32,721.00	33,480.51	36,198.00	51,144.00	53,645.00
Net Profit	61,076.00	50,232.44	31,676.00	20,410.00	14,487.00

Insurance

Export Credit Guarantee Corporation of India

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22	FY21
Gross Premium	1,366.53	1,270.76	1,197.53	1,106.62	1,062.28
Net Earned Premium	1,155.69	1,079.76	940.95	827.31	831.15
Claims Incurred	632.01	974.47	702.92	443.42	761.87
Profit Before Tax	2,723.07	2,858.95	2,761.17	1,160.86	588.10
Profit After Tax	2,076.67	2,159.05	2,164.25	875.16	460.31

Life Insurance Corporation of India

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22	FY21
Gross Premium	4,88,848.92	4,75,751.92	4,74,668.14	4,28,024.97	4,03,286.55
Net Earned Premium	4,88,148.17	4,75,069.58	4,74,004.61	4,27,419.21	4,02,844.34
Claims Incurred	-	-	-	-	-
Profit Before Tax	48,350.61	41,056.60	36,080.94	4,164.58	2,982.71
Profit After Tax	48,320.33	40,915.85	35,996.65	4,124.71	2,974.14

Oriental Insurance Company

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22	FY21
Gross Premium	20,327.48	18,794.13	15,992.61	14,020.43	12,747.42
Net Earned Premium	17,273.93	16,192.71	14,338.64	12,299.63	11,007.00
Claims Incurred	16,877.99	15,719.62	14,859.11	12,894.97	10,521.69
Profit Before Tax	67.59	37.66	-4,956.23	-3,146.87	-1,512.00
Profit After Tax	143.96	18.61	-4,968.11	-3,115.16	-1,525.44

United India Insurance Company

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22	FY21
Gross Premium	20,072.15	19,852.96	17,644.31	15,722.25	16,704.69
Net Earned Premium	17,189.90	16,614.50	15,396.84	13,436.65	14,080.65
Claims Incurred	15,973.98	16,033.69	14,060.98	13,500.02	12,302.11
Profit Before Tax	-130.03	-803.71	-2,829.33	-2,135.55	-984.68
Profit After Tax	154.03	-803.71	-2,829.33	-2,135.55	-984.68

General Insurance Corporation of India

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22	FY21
Gross Premium	41,153.95	37,181.76	36,591.59	43,208.46	47,014.38
Net Earned Premium	36,130.26	33,576.07	35,808.01	39,293.40	39,865.89
Claims Incurred	31,953.69	30,980.41	32,739.38	36,625.85	36,853.75
Profit Before Tax	8,765.64	7,877.92	7,749.44	3,560.14	3,163.38
Profit After Tax	6,701.36	6,497.30	6,312.50	2,005.74	1,920.44

National Insurance Company

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22	FY21
Gross Premium	16,833.46	15,180.28	15,900.00	13,076.84	14,185.75
Net Earned Premium	14,764.41	13,687.78	13,281.07	12,142.44	12,643.49
Claims Incurred	14,390.93	13,089.26	12,814.28	12,841.33	9,693.91
Profit Before Tax	-483.21	-198.66	-3,871.49	-1,674.70	-563.00
Profit After Tax	-483.17	-186.91	-3,871.08	-1,674.74	-561.86

The New India Assurance Company

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22	FY21
Gross Premium	41,992.21	40,363.83	37,482.04	35,514.95	31,573.42
Net Earned Premium	36,315.15	34,407.40	31,126.57	29,760.33	26,965.83
Claims Incurred	34,167.89	33,128.26	28,909.10	28,750.14	22,086.95
Profit Before Tax	1,034.48	1,445.48	1,245.22	159.91	2,036.71
Profit After Tax	988.07	1,129.33	1,055.39	164.27	1,604.69

India's Best Public Sector Undertakings

Maharatna - Manufacturing

Selection Criteria

- Having Navratna status.
- Listed on Indian stock exchange with minimum prescribed public shareholding under SEBI regulations.
- Average annual turnover of more than ₹25,000 crore, during the last 3 years.
- Average annual net worth of more than ₹15,000 crore, during the last 3 years.
- Average annual net profit after tax of more than ₹5,000 crore, during the last 3 years.
- Should have significant global presence/international operations.

Bharat Heavy Electricals Ltd.

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25
Net Sales	17,308.69	21,211.09	23,364.94	23,892.78	28,339.48
Net Profit/ PAT	-2,699.70	444.71	654.12	282.22	533.90
Net Worth	25,983.66	26,506.60	24,378.26	24,438.65	24,722.16
Capital Employed	31,211.76	31,342.53	29,193.92	29,553.42	35,789.87
EBIT	-3,129.37	918.59	1,327.80	1,070.30	1,651.68

Hindustan Petroleum Corporation Ltd.

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25
Net Sales	2,33,248.45	3,49,913.19	4,40,709.25	4,33,856.50	4,34,106.16
Net Profit/ PAT	10,662.89	7,294.23	-6,980.23	16,014.61	6,735.70
Net Worth	38,080.86	41,404.21	32,263.27	46,921.35	51,144.29
Capital Employed	71,759.39	83,188.62	87,473.62	96,434.06	98,466.92
EBIT	15,160.28	10,140.94	-7,809.81	23,056.27	12,365.36

Steel Authority Of India Ltd.

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25
Net Sales	69,113.61	1,03,476.84	1,04,447.72	1,05,378.33	1,02,479.06
Net Profit/ PAT	4,148.13	12,243.47	2,176.53	3,066.67	2,371.80
Net Worth	45,406.22	54,211.68	54,746.67	57,101.22	58,905.61
Capital Employed	72,748.24	80,766.20	81,146.81	87,244.16	90,180.85
EBIT	10,022.80	17,989.76	4,929.91	6,535.67	6,044.70

Bharat Petroleum Corporation Ltd.

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25
Net Sales	2,30,170.81	3,46,791.09	4,73,187.19	4,48,083.03	4,40,271.88
Net Profit/ PAT	17,319.83	11,681.50	2,131.05	26,858.84	13,336.55
Net Worth	5,35,550.80	5,19,056.20	5,35,223.60	7,56,351.10	8,13,840.80
Capital Employed	1,03,273.84	1,04,401.72	1,13,267.06	1,21,534.37	1,27,710.22
EBIT	24,407.32	18,642.37	7,083.90	40,343.33	21,773.74

Indian Oil Corporation Ltd.

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25
Net Sales	3,70,806.25	5,89,321.19	8,41,755.94	7,76,351.88	7,58,105.81
Net Profit/ PAT	21,762.22	25,726.60	11,704.26	43,161.15	13,788.83
Net Worth	1,11,838.05	1,33,535.19	1,39,720.23	1,83,416.27	1,86,487.31
Capital Employed	2,11,601.97	2,23,409.89	2,48,665.44	2,75,415.89	2,89,980.06
EBIT	35,175.92	39,742.69	22,625.54	65,168.42	26,377.96

NTPC Ltd.

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25
Net Sales	1,10,368.17	1,31,387.20	1,74,772.70	1,76,967.70	1,86,532.27
Net Profit/ PAT	14,969.40	16,960.29	17,121.35	21,332.45	23,953.15
Net Worth	1,25,738.47	1,35,373.73	1,47,023.17	1,60,709.27	1,84,071.16
Capital Employed	3,38,564.08	3,47,797.34	3,73,103.94	3,93,883.25	4,36,755.19
EBIT	27,045.22	31,441.81	35,364.62	40,442.16	45,480.11

Hindustan Aeronautics Ltd.

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25
Net Sales	22,882.32	24,620.02	26,927.46	30,381.08	30,980.95
Net Profit/ PAT	3,245.55	5,079.88	5,827.73	7,620.95	8,364.05
Net Worth	15,423.90	19,313.13	23,572.15	29,138.17	34,981.61
Capital Employed	26,298.40	32,803.87	35,250.82	40,316.52	60,603.61
EBIT	4,550.37	5,289.77	6,573.91	10,267.51	10,888.88

Maharatna - Non Manufacturing

Oil & Natural Gas Corporation Ltd.

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25
Net Sales	3,03,892.18	4,91,300.50	6,32,325.95	6,01,580.90	6,12,065.35
Net Profit/ PAT	21,360.25	49,294.06	34,046.46	55,273.15	38,328.61
Net Worth	2,20,981.00	2,59,502.90	2,82,775.00	3,39,068.88	3,43,440.48
Capital Employed	4,17,318.58	4,54,697.11	4,82,686.93	5,66,359.76	5,84,803.55
EBIT	36,302.46	61,084.79	54,381.55	88,253.12	68,128.76

GAIL (India) Ltd.

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25
Net Sales	57,371.91	92,769.83	1,45,668.30	1,33,228.45	1,41,903.48
Net Profit/ PAT	6,142.82	12,303.63	5,595.89	9,902.81	12,462.87
Net Worth	53,182.34	64,114.28	64,927.43	76,997.18	84,997.55
Capital Employed	70,465.00	84,870.42	87,566.47	1,05,764.11	1,11,249.22
EBIT	7,906.08	15,676.79	7,627.34	13,314.84	16,843.50

Power Finance Corporation Ltd.

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25
Net Sales	71,656.10	76,261.66	77,568.30	91,096.72	1,06,501.62
Net Profit/ PAT	15,716.20	18,768.21	21,178.59	26,461.18	30,514.40
Net Worth	60,767.48	71,676.24	84,158.49	1,01,146.77	1,17,738.35
Capital Employed	7,37,074.92	7,64,721.24	8,62,857.27	8,78,612.16	10,07,302.23
EBIT	64,578.41	68,094.32	73,521.89	91,576.66	1,03,312.52

Power Grid Corporation Of India Ltd.

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25
Net Sales	39,639.79	41,621.64	45,603.11	45,843.10	45,792.32
Net Profit/ PAT	12,036.46	16,824.07	15,419.74	15,573.16	15,521.44
Net Worth	69,936.07	76,247.13	83,026.29	87,145.11	92,662.81
Capital Employed	2,254.63	2,156.29	2,221.53	2,154.77	2,257.73
EBIT	2,385.85	2,764.59	2,733.56	2,728.67	2,799.43

Oil India Ltd.

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25
Net Sales	17,616.05	25,905.59	36,084.42	32,466.03	32,512.48
Net Profit/ PAT	4,145.97	6,719.22	9,854.39	6,980.45	7,039.63
Net Worth	23,666.42	30,561.91	38,481.49	48,338.99	49,767.72
Capital Employed	447.11	551.27	652.85	777.96	892.27
EBIT	502.91	993.03	1,404.48	980.96	1,050.57

Coal India Ltd.

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25
Net Sales	90,233.00	1,09,941.45	1,38,506.22	1,45,051.56	1,43,992.61
Net Profit/ PAT	12,702.17	17,378.42	31,722.98	37,369.13	35,302.10
Net Worth	36,517.36	43,143.04	60,842.93	82,729.78	99,104.92
Capital Employed	1,071.27	1,189.01	1,508.43	1,732.58	1,927.62
EBIT	1,865.15	2,415.78	4,395.89	4,963.20	4,784.98

REC Ltd.

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25
Net Sales	35,552.84	39,269.05	39,478.26	47,504.75	56,366.55
Net Profit/ PAT	8,378.24	10,035.69	11,166.98	14,145.46	15,884.23
Net Worth	43,763.93	51,314.10	58,120.51	69,350.24	78,376.06
Capital Employed	3,52,627.22	3,73,107.51	4,19,213.85	5,00,476.17	5,55,405.22
EBIT	32,271.47	34,484.39	37,639.01	47,924.67	54,255.50

Navratna - Manufacturing

Selection Criteria

The Miniratna Category – I and Schedule 'A' CPSEs, which have obtained 'excellent' or 'very good' rating under the Memorandum of Understanding system in three of the last five years, and have composite score of 60 or above in the six selected performance parameters, namely,

- Net profit to net worth
- Manpower cost to total cost of production/services,
- Profit before depreciation, interest and taxes to capital employed
- Profit before interest and taxes to turnover,
- Earning per share and
- Inter-sectoral performance.

India's Best Public Sector Undertakings

Navratna - Manufacturing

Bharat Electronics Ltd.

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25
Net Sales	14,108.69	15,368.18	17,734.44	20,268.24	23,768.75
Net Profit/ PAT	2,069.34	2,354.46	2,940.35	3,943.11	5,287.15
Net Worth	11,059.58	12,285.93	13,861.63	16,326.47	19,973.89
Capital Employed	12,196.66	13,708.60	14,421.67	16,925.27	20,544.48
EBIT	2,951.39	3,174.79	3,941.74	5,278.27	7,111.53

National Fertilizers Ltd.

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25
Net Sales	1,190.57	1,585.71	2,958.43	2,356.03	1,979.45
Net Profit/ PAT	23.71	-9.51	45.83	15.01	18.40
Net Worth	2,140.19	2,079.71	2,541.65	2,545.26	2,715.81
Capital Employed	51.52	48.77	51.21	44.17	44.02
EBIT	62.53	7.87	91.95	45.07	44.50

National Aluminium Company Ltd.

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25
Net Sales	895.58	1,421.46	1,425.69	1,314.92	1,678.76
Net Profit/ PAT	129.94	295.14	143.47	198.85	526.79
Net Worth	10,679.01	12,552.39	13,126.37	14,388.09	17,805.44
Capital Employed	126.59	142.41	147.41	159.95	193.84
EBIT	132.35	397.74	186.31	272.93	713.73

Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Ltd.

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25
Net Sales	404.78	573.33	782.72	946.66	1,143.19
Net Profit/ PAT	45.35	56.31	104.61	180.89	227.73
Net Worth	3,431.71	3,857.68	4,760.16	6,243.47	7,939.88
Capital Employed	3,925.50	4,139.39	4,873.22	7,655.78	10,493.78
EBIT	61.46	76.43	141.38	243.95	307.49

Rashtriya Chemicals and Fertilizers Ltd.

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25
Net Sales	8,281.18	12,812.17	21,451.54	16,981.31	16,933.64
Net Profit/ PAT	384.07	702.39	966.31	225.28	242.45
Net Worth	3,351.31	3,881.87	4,590.12	4,605.74	4,745.33
Capital Employed	5,081.65	5,478.74	6,124.09	6,135.65	6,262.40
EBIT	711.55	1,071.79	1,507.46	495.32	587.63

Ircon International Ltd.

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25
Net Sales	534.98	737.97	1,036.79	1,251.37	1,075.96
Net Profit/ PAT	39.11	59.23	76.52	92.95	72.78
Net Worth	4,403.13	4,665.62	5,211.49	5,870.92	6,326.35
Capital Employed	54.00	70.98	81.63	103.15	121.50
EBIT	84.29	93.10	119.23	151.33	120.69

Shipping Corporation Of India Ltd.

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25
Net Sales	37,032.90	49,880.80	57,940.10	50,465.30	56,058.30
Net Profit/ PAT	6,960.90	8,605.40	8,701.60	6,789.70	8,435.80
Net Worth	8,16,753.00	5,97,418.00	6,90,233.00	7,53,950.00	8,31,175.00
Capital Employed	10,973.22	8,212.19	8,650.83	9,183.69	10,071.71
EBIT	8,204.30	10,653.10	9,879.50	8,165.10	10,391.20

NMDC Ltd.

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25
Net Sales	1,537.01	2,596.48	1,766.69	2,130.79	2,390.55
Net Profit/ PAT	624.71	944.11	553.84	557.22	653.98
Net Worth	29,884.05	18,018.25	22,620.83	25,655.90	29,695.77
Capital Employed	311.16	187.11	237.49	269.90	310.42
EBIT	891.23	1,305.53	772.18	803.09	932.16

Container Corporation Of India Ltd.

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25
Net Sales	642.71	765.27	816.91	865.34	888.70
Net Profit/ PAT	50.07	105.35	117.36	124.85	129.18
Net Worth	10,187.26	10,753.92	11,226.29	11,826.52	12,380.19
Capital Employed	110.11	114.69	120.24	127.14	132.64
EBIT	71.71	145.86	162.80	172.66	179.44

Engineers India Ltd.

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25
Net Sales	31,443.38	29,120.10	33,282.49	32,821.64	30,876.15
Net Profit/ PAT	2,614.56	3,428.89	3,442.35	3,601.61	4,719.03
Net Worth	1,75,070.77	1,77,004.08	1,96,151.89	2,24,630.02	2,66,928.09
Capital Employed	2,083.52	1,953.73	1,890.08	2,193.84	2,645.35
EBIT	3,620.91	4,522.16	4,485.22	4,832.16	6,351.85

Navratna - Manufacturing

Indian Railway Catering & Tourism Corp. Ltd.

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25
Net Sales	77,665.77	1,87,857.44	3,54,147.28	4,26,021.34	4,67,477.09
Net Profit/ PAT	18,702.64	65,955.29	1,00,588.11	1,11,107.73	1,31,490.23
Net Worth	1,45,581.14	1,87,031.36	2,47,840.41	3,22,978.84	3,66,336.50
Capital Employed	1,538.58	1,991.46	2,566.84	3,318.21	3,763.84
EBIT	2,657.91	8,964.27	13,701.22	15,146.87	17,741.78

Indian Renewable Energy Devp. Agency Ltd.

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25
Net Sales	2,61,394.55	2,85,989.94	3,48,197.50	4,963.93	6,743.32
Net Profit/ PAT	34,640.72	63,352.65	86,462.83	1,252.24	1,698.34
Net Worth	2,99,559.91	5,26,811.31	5,93,516.94	8,55,942.00	10,26,654.00
Capital Employed	28,617.48	35,423.50	50,739.41	525.06	654.67
EBIT	21,397.79	24,210.90	32,276.87	484.94	624.46

NBCC (India) Ltd.

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25
Net Sales	6,95,340.94	7,69,060.75	8,87,636.81	10,40,678.75	12,03,857.25
Net Profit/ PAT	24,010.36	23,792.77	27,800.83	41,437.71	55,742.46
Net Worth	1,64,310.17	1,76,772.13	1,94,450.14	2,22,562.03	2,47,905.69
Capital Employed	1,864.08	2,048.93	2,043.27	2,378.90	2,624.17
EBIT	5,131.72	4,937.88	5,677.13	7,729.36	9,227.01

Rail Vikas Nigam Ltd.

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25
Net Sales	15,403.76	19,381.71	20,281.57	21,878.53	19,923.02
Net Profit/ PAT	991.57	1,110.14	1,341.75	1,550.87	1,281.52
Net Worth	5,636.08	6,324.69	7,246.19	8,721.83	9,570.71
Capital Employed	116.69	129.49	138.87	149.95	147.84
EBIT	166.49	199.33	230.07	259.85	218.96

Rites Ltd.

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25
Net Sales	1,905.30	2,661.83	2,628.27	2,452.85	2,217.81
Net Profit/ PAT	444.21	538.58	570.97	495.20	423.66
Net Worth	2,391.97	2,488.64	2,603.78	2,609.01	2,640.15
Capital Employed	27.11	27.77	29.87	28.98	29.10
EBIT	59.86	74.24	78.10	67.51	57.08

Housing & Urban Development Corp. Ltd.

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25
Net Sales	7,234.58	6,954.08	7,049.46	7,784.29	10,311.29
Net Profit/ PAT	1,578.50	1,716.41	1,701.43	2,116.69	2,709.14
Net Worth	13,187.74	14,466.82	15,443.56	16,612.56	17,968.05
Capital Employed	736.24	725.79	658.50	756.47	951.53
EBIT	699.34	687.83	679.63	780.42	1,038.42

NHPC Ltd.

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25
Net Sales	9,647.89	9,144.20	10,607.40	9,630.96	10,379.86
Net Profit/ PAT	3,599.88	3,774.33	4,260.83	3,999.54	3,411.73
Net Worth	33,053.30	34,920.98	36,960.67	38,668.59	39,668.16
Capital Employed	663.73	697.70	772.89	824.78	912.83
EBIT	507.13	380.36	575.99	575.98	595.61

SJVN Ltd.

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25
Net Sales	248.54	241.70	293.84	257.94	307.20
Net Profit/ PAT	164.57	98.98	135.93	91.14	81.80
Net Worth	12,791.29	13,170.34	13,859.54	14,070.85	14,178.65
Capital Employed	16,476.28	21,740.40	28,082.84	35,382.81	41,878.18
EBIT	222.55	154.15	217.65	165.58	184.23

Railtel Corporation Of India Ltd.

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25
Net Sales	1,377.82	1,548.45	1,963.51	2,567.82	3,477.50
Net Profit/ PAT	142.45	208.94	189.07	246.21	299.81
Net Worth	1,412.82	1,526.71	1,648.88	1,827.24	1,999.62
Capital Employed	1,565.85	1,646.77	1,795.50	1,910.43	2,155.56
EBIT	203.86	289.50	266.86	341.77	414.58

Indian Railway Finance Corporation Ltd.

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25
Net Sales	15,770.47	20,299.26	23,721.42	26,648.63	27,152.14
Net Profit/ PAT	4,416.13	6,089.84	6,167.16	6,412.11	6,502.00
Net Worth	35,913.38	40,996.34	44,680.18	49,178.57	52,667.77
Capital Employed	3,56,135.72	4,29,424.73	4,63,622.07	4,50,580.50	4,48,634.87
EBIT	15,653.18	20,164.94	23,614.36	26,513.58	26,997.09

Navratna - Non Manufacturing

Mahanagar Telephone Nigam Ltd.

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25
Net Sales	1,387.71	1,149.04	935.26	798.56	698.02
Net Profit/ PAT	-2,461.26	-2,603.13	-2,915.11	-3,267.52	-3,327.69
Net Worth	-16,044.51	-18,668.27	-20,854.96	-23,644.10	-26,918.97
Capital Employed	2,859.59	-1,297.30	-693.65	1,046.44	-2,767.29
EBIT	-341.92	-452.77	-551.63	-573.78	-400.11

NLC India Ltd.

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25
Net Sales	984.61	1,194.79	1,616.52	1,300.13	1,528.30
Net Profit/ PAT	131.40	111.51	142.51	186.73	271.34
Net Worth	13,484.81	14,189.18	15,168.84	16,531.05	18,722.97
Capital Employed	385.84	408.18	420.17	440.78	459.53
EBIT	353.56	358.69	306.75	373.09	462.87

Miniratna - Manufacturing

Selection Criteria

CPSEs that have reported profits continuously for the last three years, with a pre-tax profit of ₹30 crore or more in at least one of those three years, and have a positive net worth are eligible to be considered for the grant of Miniratna Category-I status. CPSEs that have reported profits continuously for the last three years and have a positive net worth are eligible to be considered for the grant of Miniratna Category-II status.

BEML Ltd.

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25
Net Sales	3,596.83	4,337.49	3,898.95	4,054.32	4,022.22
Net Profit/ PAT	68.70	128.59	157.89	281.77	292.52
Net Worth	2,214.41	2,356.69	2,421.48	2,667.97	2,887.38
Capital Employed	3,447.04	3,518.10	3,115.21	3,445.04	3,903.18
EBIT	135.13	273.28	334.61	432.10	466.66

Mangalore Refinery And Petrochemicals Ltd.

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25
Net Sales	31,959.03	69,757.78	1,09,026.00	90,406.68	94,681.63
Net Profit/ PAT	-764.97	2,958.25	2,655.41	3,597.06	56.21
Net Worth	4,248.10	7,209.35	9,864.53	13,282.52	12,969.65
Capital Employed	20,096.21	20,852.34	23,186.05	25,007.21	25,136.36
EBIT	-77.76	3,923.40	5,554.02	6,641.80	1,134.55

Chennai Petroleum Corporation Ltd.

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25
Net Sales	2,244.48	4,337.54	7,673.47	6,638.57	5,935.60
Net Profit/ PAT	25.73	135.20	353.15	274.51	21.41
Net Worth	161.12	298.67	647.51	882.09	820.67
Capital Employed	551.85	635.36	1,055.98	1,303.96	959.72
EBIT	167.27	225.45	513.71	391.78	49.33

HMT Ltd.

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25
Net Sales	2,046.09	1,783.72	2,077.24	1,663.76	1,441.60
Net Profit/ PAT	-1,122.80	-1,450.99	-1,247.57	-1,300.78	-1,430.54
Net Worth	-47,137.44	-41,801.58	-43,031.36	-17,520.29	-18,978.98
Capital Employed	154.46	167.06	203.46	386.63	303.13
EBIT	-240.28	-705.86	-477.88	-649.55	-703.94

Hindustan Organic Chemicals Ltd.

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25
Net Sales	4,152.47	4,336.77	6,314.36	7,038.90	5,358.68
Net Profit/ PAT	-82.87	-323.17	-508.60	-553.17	3,915.41
Net Worth	3,153.48	-477.47	-5,027.10	-5,143.44	1,04,534.00
Capital Employed	268.61	152.90	90.65	100.21	1,196.98
EBIT	453.32	332.84	160.27	142.57	4,377.31

Hindustan Copper Ltd.

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25
Net Sales	17,867.61	18,219.33	16,773.35	17,169.96	20,709.68
Net Profit/ PAT	1,104.40	3,740.84	2,953.21	2,957.28	4,674.16
Net Worth	1,08,924.85	1,91,123.06	2,08,217.44	2,28,510.78	2,66,091.03
Capital Employed	1,765.41	1,965.04	2,164.09	2,550.27	2,864.06
EBIT	1,558.89	4,125.81	4,129.80	4,273.38	6,401.63

Miniratna - Manufacturing

Balmer Lawrie & Company Ltd.

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25
Net Sales	15,289.85	20,553.45	23,214.84	23,392.27	25,156.36
Net Profit/ PAT	825.93	886.96	1,068.74	1,993.08	1,948.17
Net Worth	1,54,201.75	1,58,701.38	1,68,072.67	1,82,079.83	1,96,866.45
Capital Employed	1,855.10	1,918.91	2,019.59	2,161.49	2,343.33
EBIT	1,347.00	1,496.23	1,822.57	2,965.40	3,023.33

Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers Ltd.

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25
Net Sales	1,14,083.53	1,75,444.88	2,56,114.52	3,59,264.22	5,07,568.78
Net Profit/ PAT	15,347.12	18,952.68	22,812.40	35,726.77	52,740.38
Net Worth	1,13,711.76	1,25,789.07	1,41,381.75	1,67,343.89	2,07,926.23
Capital Employed	1,375.33	1,579.09	1,637.52	2,022.56	2,399.41
EBIT	2,172.13	2,590.72	3,156.22	4,972.37	7,191.50

MOIL Ltd.

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25
Net Sales	1,177.38	1,436.30	1,341.65	1,449.42	1,584.94
Net Profit/ PAT	176.63	376.98	250.59	293.34	381.64
Net Worth	2,819.90	2,141.51	2,244.32	2,453.07	2,637.90
Capital Employed	2,868.49	2,188.78	2,286.17	2,503.89	2,721.79
EBIT	240.11	524.03	334.45	387.00	432.56

Mishra Dhatu Nigam Ltd.

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25
Net Sales	81,323.08	85,949.02	87,194.14	1,07,267.45	1,07,410.15
Net Profit/ PAT	16,642.28	17,661.73	15,626.45	9,178.18	11,083.74
Net Worth	1,07,113.49	1,18,953.28	1,28,539.60	1,31,916.34	1,41,496.84
Capital Employed	1,816.61	1,977.33	2,061.90	2,130.28	2,229.09
EBIT	2,389.15	2,619.97	2,438.45	1,669.37	1,872.39

Cochin Shipyard Ltd.

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25
Net Sales	281.89	319.09	236.46	383.05	482.00
Net Profit/ PAT	60.87	56.40	30.47	78.33	82.73
Net Worth	4,033.45	4,393.18	4,427.65	5,003.34	5,579.26
Capital Employed	4,461.53	4,835.88	4,797.25	5,421.75	6,012.49
EBIT	86.64	81.91	46.17	111.72	118.04

Miniratna - Non Manufacturing

MMTC Ltd.

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25
Net Sales	3,000.15	1,179.62	352.82	0.53	0.27
Net Profit/ PAT	-78.93	-25.82	156.23	19.22	8.66
Net Worth	99.74	-148.09	1,411.76	1,625.68	1,702.19
Capital Employed	-4.08	-3.21	13.06	14.97	15.74
EBIT	-90.59	32.90	189.00	20.15	12.01

India Tourism Development Corporation Ltd.

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25
Net Sales	1,772.35	2,943.24	4,608.20	5,088.85	5,703.97
Net Profit/ PAT	-346.49	40.95	546.09	649.24	813.52
Net Worth	28,103.61	28,331.73	33,800.21	30,594.05	36,378.39
Capital Employed	293.73	289.12	343.44	286.36	334.07
EBIT	-326.84	84.71	813.75	1,053.75	997.77

MSTC Ltd.

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25
Net Sales	78,046.61	87,614.78	72,096.65	31,624.91	31,095.96
Net Profit/ PAT	11,295.88	19,909.58	24,195.67	16,504.48	40,707.21
Net Worth	55,795.33	65,404.24	78,650.39	64,706.60	73,841.39
Capital Employed	893.88	1,028.52	1,230.23	1,069.74	1,222.59
EBIT	1,438.22	2,357.29	3,293.31	2,780.54	5,083.26

KIOCL Ltd.

(₹/Cr)

Particulars	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25
Net Sales	237.64	300.65	154.34	185.43	59.05
Net Profit/ PAT	30.12	31.34	-9.77	-8.33	-20.46
Net Worth	1,985.99	2,143.64	2,002.04	1,918.50	1,711.50
Capital Employed	2,183.14	2,343.33	2,197.61	2,127.37	1,966.55
EBIT	42.54	42.34	-10.90	-4.91	-18.97

The Green Shift: Renewable Stocks Charge Ahead

India's renewable energy story has moved beyond policy ambition to market reality. From solar manufacturers and green power producers to utilities pivoting towards cleaner portfolios, the listed space is beginning to reflect India's energy transition. Yet, the real opportunity lies in identifying companies where growth, execution, valuation and resilience come together

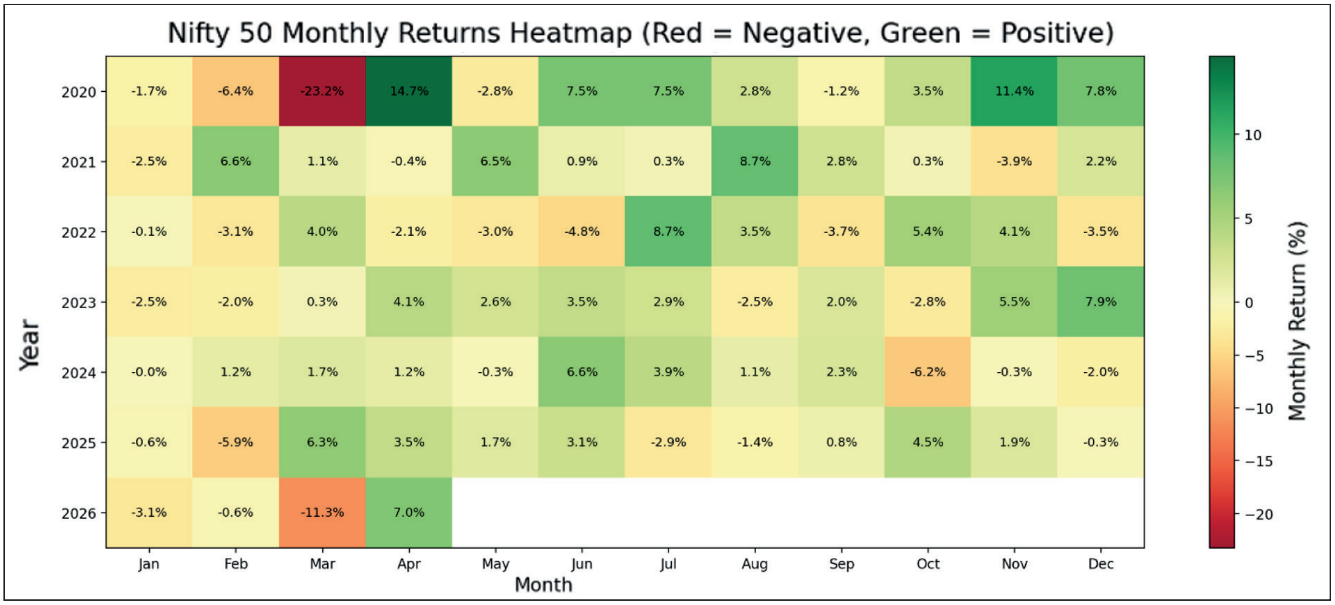
The Hormuz Hedge: When Geopolitics Meets the Grid

In March 2026, the global energy order faced a 'second fossil shock' in just four years. As the U.S.-Iran conflict escalated into a naval blockade of the Strait of Hormuz, crude oil prices breached the USD 100-per-barrel mark, sending shockwaves through energy-import-dependent economies. As the U.S.- Iran conflict escalated and trade tariffs tightened, the Nifty 50 plummeted by 11.31 per cent, its steepest decline since the pandemic shock of March 2020, under the weight of inflationary fears and supply chain disruptions; the equity indices plunged at the open as investors braced for a macroeconomic slowdown.

wide on a weekly basis, but it still indicates better relative strength in renewable counters.

The real outperformance becomes visible in the one-month performance. Renewable companies delivered an average return of 18.66 per cent, compared with 11.65 per cent for non-renewable companies, leading by nearly 7 percentage points.

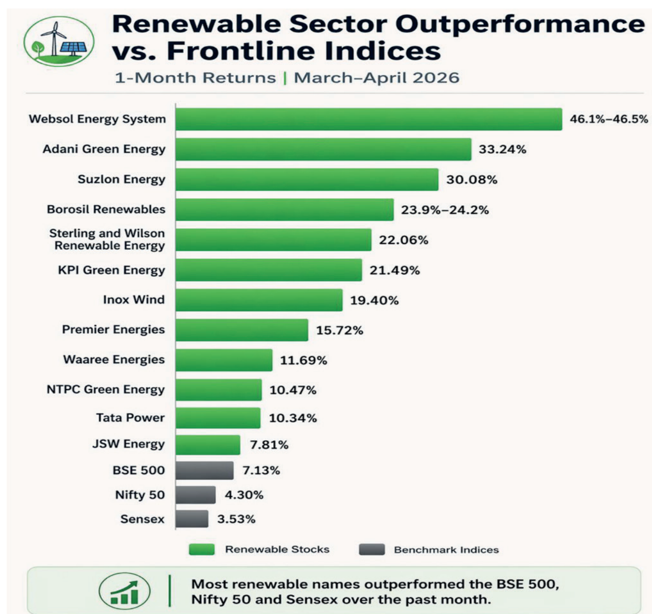
This suggests that investor interest has been stronger in renewable-energy-linked names, possibly due to improving sector sentiment, policy support, clean energy transition themes and stronger momentum in select solar, hydro and green power stocks.



The Rise of Renewable Energy Stocks

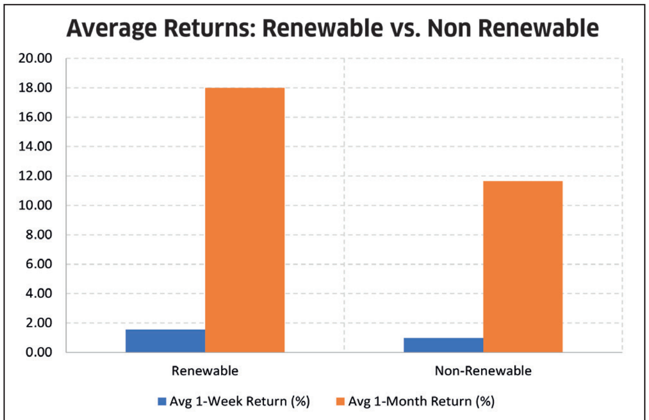
Yet, amidst the red on the screens, a specific sector decoupled from the carnage. While traditional 'old economy' stocks tumbled, India's renewable energy players emerged as the 'unintended beneficiaries' of the crisis. This was not speculative euphoria; it was a rational flight to energy sovereignty. For sophisticated investors, the conflict served as a high-stakes proof-of-concept: renewable energy is no longer just a 'green' thematic, it is a strategic defensive play against global volatility. The data from the last month tells a story of massive outperformance, where clean energy stocks did not just survive the geopolitical storm; they thrived in it.

If we analyse the individual constituents of the BSE Power & Energy index, the data clearly shows that renewable-energy-linked companies have outperformed non-renewable power and energy companies over both timeframes. In the last one week, renewable companies delivered an average return of 1.32 per cent, slightly ahead of the 0.98 per cent average return posted by non-renewable companies. The difference is not very



The outperformance of players like Websol Energy (+46 per cent) and Adani Green (+33 per cent) against the Sensex (+3.53 per cent) highlights a critical shift in investor psychology. We are witnessing the transition from 'valuation by promise' to 'valuation by necessity'

Category	No. of Companies	Avg. 1-Week Return (%)	Avg. 1-Month Return (%)	Positive 1-Month Count
Renewable	11	1.32	18.66	11
Non-Renewable	25	0.98	11.65	24



The Bigger Picture: India's Energy Transition and Macroeconomic Resilience

The macroeconomic backdrop for India remains structurally strong, with GDP growth expected to stay around the 6.6–6.9 per cent range despite global uncertainties. This economic momentum is also placing India at the centre of the global energy demand story, with the International Energy Agency's World Energy Outlook 2025 indicating that India will account for the largest absolute increase in global energy demand through 2035.

India's total power generation during FY 2025-26 reached 1,845.921 billion units (BU), while the country's peak electricity demand is projected at 277 GW for FY 2026-27, according to the 20th Electric Power Survey published by the Central Electricity Authority.

The transition is being driven through a coordinated, whole-of-government approach, with climate and energy priorities increasingly integrated across policy frameworks.

India achieved the landmark target of 50 per cent cumulative installed electric power capacity from non-fossil fuel sources in June 2025, five years ahead of its 2030 target under the Nationally Determined Contribution to the Paris Agreement.

As of March 31, 2026, India's total non-fossil fuel installed capacity stood at 283.46 GW, comprising 274.68 GW of renewable energy and 8.78 GW of nuclear power capacity.

Macroeconomic and Energy Indicators	Value (FY 2025-26 Estimates)
GDP Growth Projection	~7%
Total Electricity Generation Target	2,000 BU
Peak Power Demand (FY26)	277 GW
Cumulative Non-Fossil Capacity	283.46 GW
Share of Non-Fossil in Total Generation	29.2%
Non-Fossil Generation Capacity Growth (YoY)	55.29 GW

The redirection of capital is equally stark. Over the last decade, the ratio of investment flows for fossil fuel versus non-fossil fuel capacity has transformed from 1:1 to 1:4. For investors, this represents a structural de-risking; renewables are now the primary solution for India's energy future.

Why the Renewable Story Looks Compelling: The Economic Flywheel

The investment case for Indian renewables in 2026 is built on the convergence of technological deflation and massive domestic value addition. The 'Economic Flywheel' is powered by Production Linked Incentive (PLI) schemes. Solar module manufacturing capacity has surged to approximately 172 GW, while wind turbine manufacturing capacity has reached 24 GW.

Policy measures like the Approved List of Models and Manufacturers (ALMM) have created a protected environment for domestic champions. In September 2025, the government further bolstered project economics by reducing the GST rate on renewable energy equipment from 12 per cent to 5 per cent. These fiscal tailwinds provide a level of policy predictability that institutional investors prize.

The Storage Tipping Point and Grid Stability

2026 marks a critical inflection point for India's energy storage industry as it moves from tendering to operational execution. Battery energy storage system (BESS) capacity additions are expected to rise nearly tenfold in 2026, reaching around 5 GWh compared with 507 MWh in 2025, driven by a large backlog of projects moving into implementation.

Energy Storage Market Outlook	2025 Status	2026 Projection	2033 Target
BESS Installed Capacity	507 MWh	5,000 MWh (5 GWh)	346 GWh
Pumped Hydro Capacity	3.3 GW	7 GW (Emerging)	107 GW
Standalone BESS Tariff (2-hr)	₹2.21 L/MW/mo	₹1.48 L/MW/mo	-

The sharp decline in storage costs is the primary driver. Turnkey battery costs fell by 40 per cent in 2024 and another 31 per cent in 2025. This deflation has led to aggressive pricing in recent tenders, with standalone two-hour BESS tariffs dropping to ₹1.48 lakh per MW per month.

The Market Opportunity: Numbers That Matter

Solar energy remains the undisputed heavyweight, crossing the 150 GW milestone in March 2026. Distributed Renewable Energy (DRE) has emerged as a high-growth frontier, contributing 16.31 GW in the FY 2025-26 fiscal year alone.

Rooftop solar, supported by the PM Surya Ghar: Muft Bijli Yojana, has benefited over 3.4 million households. The programme targets 10 million households by 2027. This shift towards distributed generation reduces the 'single-offtaker' risk associated with state DISCOMs.

Solar Sub-Sector Capacity (March 2026)	Capacity (GW)	Growth Driver
Utility-Scale Solar	110.43 GW	Large Solar Parks, Competitive Bidding
Rooftop Solar	25.73 GW	PM Surya Ghar Scheme
PM-KUSUM & Off-Grid	14.10 GW	Solar Water Pumps for Agriculture
Total Solar Installed	150.26 GW	-
Solar PV Manufacturing	172.00 GW	PLI Scheme, ALMM Mandates

Wind energy has also experienced a renaissance, with FY 2025-26 recording a record annual capacity addition of 6.05 GW. A significant 75 per cent of these additions were driven by Commercial and Industrial (C&I) segments.

The Bull Case: Why This Could Be a Multi-Year Investment Theme

The 'Bull Case' is anchored in India's ambition to become a global hub for green hydrogen. The National Green Hydrogen Mission, with a target of 5 MMTPA by 2030, is expected to attract USD 100 billion in investments. While current output is in the pilot phase, with about 8,000 tonnes commissioned by February 2026, players like JSW Steel, GAIL and Adani New Industries are already commissioning facilities.

Green Hydrogen Mission Targets (2030)	Expected Impact
Production Capacity	At least 5 MMTPA
Renewable Energy Addition	~125 GW
Total Investment Attracted	> ₹8 lakh crore ($100B+)
Jobs Created	> 6 lakh
CO2 Emissions Avoided	~50 MMT annually

The bull case is further strengthened by the expanding green finance ecosystem. The latest India-specific sustainable debt data from Climate Bonds Initiative and MUFG shows that India's cumulative aligned Green, Social, Sustainability and Sustainability-linked debt (GSS+) reached USD 55.9 billion by December 2024, up 186 per cent since 2021.

Green debt continued to dominate the market, accounting for 83 per cent of the total aligned volume, while 2024 alone saw USD 12.5 billion of aligned GSS+ issuance.

The Bear Case: Risks Investors Cannot Ignore

The primary operational risk is the '42 GW challenge', renewable capacity at risk of being 'stranded' due to transmission bottlenecks. In Rajasthan, over 4,000 MW of commissioned capacity is unable to evacuate power during peak hours due to grid congestion. While the Green Energy Corridor (GEC) programmes aim to integrate 500 GW by 2030, Phase I and Phase II have faced repeated delays due to land acquisition and Right-of-Way (RoW) disputes.

Key Implementation Challenges	Impact on Investors
Transmission Congestion	Potential curtailment and revenue loss
DISCOM Financial Health	Unpaid dues exceeding $9 billion as of 2025
U.S. Trade Protectionism	Tariffs on Indian modules reaching 126%
Manufacturing Gaps	Reliance on imports for 90% of solar cells

The second major risk is geopolitical trade. U.S. tariffs on Indian solar modules surged to 126 per cent by February 2026. While domestic demand is expected to absorb capacity, the loss of high-margin U.S. exports, which were 40–60 per cent more profitable than domestic sales, will weigh on earnings for export-heavy manufacturers.

Listed Space vs. Reality: Pricing in the Future

Indian renewable stocks trade at a 'growth premium'. Adani Green Energy trades at a trailing P/E of approximately 98x to 134x, reflecting its position as the owner of an operational portfolio of 19.3 GW. Tata Power offers a steadier medium-term compounder profile, with plans to expand renewable capacity to 23 GW by 2030. However, the 'reality' is that the market is moving from a phase of 'valuation by announcement' to 'valuation by execution'. In the manufacturing space, Websol Energy has seen revenue rise 77 per cent YoY with a high ROCE of 59.2 per cent, yet its valuation remains below industry medians, suggesting selective opportunities still exist in the small-cap space.

Where Smart Money Is Moving: The Evolution of Private Equity

Private Equity and Venture Capital (PE/VC) activity in India reached USD 60.7 billion in 2025, with real assets contributing more than one-third of the total capital. Brookfield's USD 12 billion investment commitment in Andhra Pradesh is the benchmark for this trend, focusing on solar, wind and storage-powered data centres.

The focus of 'Smart Money' includes:

- **FDRE Platforms:** Investing in 'Firm and Dispatchable' power, like the Evren platform's USD 600 million 1 GW project.
- **Integrated Manufacturing:** Capital is flowing into upstream ingot and wafer manufacturing to reduce dependency on China.

Top Listed Players In Renewable Energy*

Company	Renewable Angle	Quant Score	Market Cap. (₹ Cr.)	1W Return (%)	1M Return (%)	1Y Return (%)	PE (x)	PB (x)	ROCE (%)	ROE (%)	OPM (%)	Sales Growth 3Y (%)	Profit Growth 3Y (%)
Adani Green Energy	Pure-play renewables	61.40	2,03,558.03	9.62	44.74	35.42	112.34	10.20	7.02	11.29	83.29	18.47	16.94
ACME Solar Holdings	Solar power producer	58.30	18,500.32	0.21	20.14	43.83	36.87	3.87	8.42	7.57	88.58	-1.89	48.26
Torrent Power	Wind/solar + utility	65.80	85,638.41	8.59	22.10	10.46	27.12	4.55	15.95	19.03	19.03	26.94	48.09
Tata Power Company	Solar + power transition	48.80	1,38,997.27	1.73	11.34	12.23	36.75	3.69	10.81	10.97	20.08	15.21	20.56
JP Power Ventures	Hydro/renewable exposure	62.60	13,220.32	0.47	26.33	28.09	21.33	1.04	10.26	6.85	29.61	5.71	96.34
JSW Energy	Renewable-led power transition	44.70	95,763.64	1.28	10.25	12.90	41.37	3.27	6.49	7.41	51.27	12.88	1.78
NTPC Green Energy	Pure-play renewables	38.00	92,950.84	-1.47	14.10	6.70	166.35	4.96	4.89	3.85	86.79		
SJVN	Hydro/solar/wind pipeline	36.90	30,593.46	-0.98	14.69	-19.44	48.37	2.10	4.91	5.81	72.99	8.32	-6.66
NHPC	Hydro-led renewables	35.40	81,023.25	-3.47	4.48	-6.29	25.65	1.96	7.42	7.53	46.02	4.15	-2.87

**Forming part of BSE Power & Energy Sector*

- **Sustainable Digital Infrastructure:** Convergence of data centres and dedicated green energy hubs.

Timing the Opportunity: Is Now the Hour?

The timing of an investment in Indian renewables in 2026 is governed by the transition from 'Structural Ambition' to 'Operational Reality'. Catalysts suggesting 2026 is a superior entry point include:

1. **Monetary Easing:** The RBI's 125 bps repo rate reduction is lowering financing costs for capital-intensive projects.
2. **Storage Affordability:** With battery costs reaching a 'tipping point', solar-plus-storage is now cheaper than coal in 7 of India's 10 largest states.
3. **Regulatory Enforcement:** The 2026 Electricity (Amendment) Bill provides the legal teeth to enforce renewable purchase obligations.

Conclusion: So, Is It the Right Time?

The evidence from the 2026 investment cycle leads to a definitive conclusion: India's renewable energy sector is no longer an 'emerging opportunity' but a 'core allocation'. The achievement of the 50 per cent non-fossil capacity target five years early provides proof-of-concept for the country's institutional capacity and regulatory framework's durability.

India's renewable energy story is no longer limited to policy ambition; it is now visible across listed companies, from pure solar and green power platforms to large utilities pivoting towards cleaner energy. However, the most attractive renewable energy stocks are not necessarily the fastest-moving names. The stronger candidates are those that combine thematic purity, earnings visibility, operating quality, reasonable valuation comfort and market momentum—characteristics increasingly evident in India's maturing renewable ecosystem.

For the sophisticated investor, the strategy should favour integrated platforms and storage-linked projects. While the listed equity space may carry high P/E multiples, the underlying project internal rate of returns (IRRs) remain attractive, supported by falling technology costs and an insatiable demand for power. The convergence of monetary easing, declining battery costs reaching a true tipping point, and strengthened regulatory enforcement through the 2026 Electricity Amendment Bill creates an unprecedented window. Storage affordability has now made solar-plus-storage cheaper than coal across 7 of India's 10 largest states.

The risks, particularly transmission bottlenecks and U.S. trade tariffs, are real, but manageable for developers with domestic manufacturing capabilities and supply chain diversification.

As the U.S.-Iran conflict recently demonstrated, the 'Green Alpha' in India is not just about climate goals, it is about economic resilience in a fragmented world. The transition from 'valuation by promise' to 'valuation by necessity'—evidenced by renewable stocks thriving during the March 2026 market turmoil—underscores a fundamental shift in investor psychology. The sector's growth trajectory, underpinned by structural demand, the PLI-powered economic flywheel, expanding green finance ecosystems, and accelerating private equity commitments, positions it as a hedge against geopolitical volatility. For those with a five-to-ten-year horizon, the right time to invest in India's renewable energy was yesterday; the next best time is now.

YoY Qtr. Sales Growth (%)	YoY Qtr. Profit Growth (%)	Promoter Holding (%)	Last quarter change		Debt/ Market Cap (x)	Here is Why	Risk/Watchpoint
			DII Change (%)	FII Change (%)			
13.96	55.75	62.43	0.25	-0.32	0.51	Strongest pure-play renewable candidate; sharp 1-month momentum and robust latest quarterly profit growth, but valuation remains demanding.	Rich valuation
42.34	-3.66	83.29	0.18	-0.43	0.70	Pure solar platform with strong 1-year return and high operating margin; leverage and latest profit dip need monitoring.	Profit dip; High leverage
4.28	35.20	51.09	0.08	0.08	0.12	Best blend of profitability, growth and recent price momentum among diversified utilities; renewable exposure is meaningful but not pure-play.	Balanced profile
-9.37	-25.10	46.86	0.78	0.04	0.50	Large transition story with solar and distribution presence; respectable long-term growth but recent quarterly weakness limits ranking.	Profit dip
1.35	-97.02	24.00	0.00	0.07	0.27	Momentum and valuation screen well, but low promoter holding and steep quarterly profit decline make it more speculative.	Profit dip
67.36	173.41	69.42	-0.10	0.24	0.72	Strong latest quarterly growth and renewable transition narrative; higher debt intensity keeps it below the top tier.	High leverage
29.34	-73.36	89.01	0.27	0.00	0.23	High thematic purity and strong promoter backing; current profitability and valuation metrics need to catch up.	Rich valuation; Profit dip
61.25	50.56	81.85	-0.25	0.06	0.97	Hydro-led PSU renewable play with strong latest quarterly growth; weak 1-year return and high debt intensity weigh on appeal.	High leverage; Weak 1Y return
-2.89	-5.24	67.40	0.47	-0.05	0.55	Defensive hydro-led renewable exposure; growth and momentum are modest compared with peers.	Profit dip; Weak 1Y return

Honasa Consumer Limited

From Cautionary Tale to Comeback Story

What started as a mother's frustration over toxic baby products has grown into eight brands sitting on India's fastest-growing shelf with one very painful detour along the way

Thirty-one per cent in a month is not a number that goes unnoticed, especially when it belongs to a stock that spent most of last year being held up as everything wrong with India's Direct to Consumers (D2C) boom. Honasa Consumer was the cautionary tale: a company that grew too fast, pushed too much inventory into a distribution network that could not absorb it, and paid the price in a 57 per cent stock collapse that erased years of post-IPO goodwill. Then came the quarter that changed the conversation. Profits nearly doubled. Volumes surged 30 per cent. Margins, which had collapsed to 3.3 per cent for the full year, came back at 10.9 per cent. Walk into most Indian bathrooms today and the shelf presence was always there. It was the business model behind it that the market had stopped trusting. In this piece, we unpack everything: the business model, the numbers that matter, what went wrong in 2024, and the triggers that could make or break this story going forward.

About the Company

In 2016, Varun and Ghazal Alagh launched Mamaearth out of a straightforward frustration that safe, toxin-free baby care products simply did not exist on Indian shelves. Varun's institutional pedigree from Hindustan Unilever, Diageo and Coca-Cola, combined with Ghazal's role as Chief Innovation Officer driving Research and Development (R&D) and product development, created an unusual founding combination: FMCG discipline married to startup agility. Today, Honasa is a listed 'House of Brands' with eight personal care labels spanning skincare, haircare, baby care and colour cosmetics: Mamaearth, The Derma Co., Aqualogica, BBlunt, Dr. Sheth's, Staze, Ayuga and the newly acquired Reginald Men. The company operates across 2.7 lakh retail outlets covering 750+ districts, with an omni-channel presence across e-commerce (Amazon, Nykaa), quick-commerce (Blinkit, Zepto), modern trade (DMart, Reliance, Apollo) and a rebuilt general trade network. While India remains the dominant revenue contributor, international markets accounted for approximately ₹57.5 crore out of a total ₹2,066.9 crore in FY25 revenue, just under 3 per cent, yet the international ambition is real and expanding. The company already operates through a Dubai trading entity, has an Indonesia subsidiary in early stages, and management has signalled intent to build meaningful overseas presence over the medium term. For now, the domestic compounding story is the investment thesis; the international optionality is a long-dated bonus. The company does not own or operate a single manufacturing plant. All products are made by third-party contract manufacturers while Honasa retains ownership of formulations, quality standards and brand Intellectual Property (IP). That architectural choice, IP and marketing company, over manufacturer, is what defines every line of its P&L.

What Honasa Actually Does

The cleanest way to understand this business: Honasa makes its money between the laboratory and the consumer's screen, not in the factory. It identifies consumer need - states, develops proprietary formulations through its in-house R&D team, contracts manufacturing out, and then deploys a high-intensity marketing engine, performance digital, influencer content, quick-commerce placements and offline distribution to convert brand awareness into purchase. The intellectual property sits in the product and the brand. Honasa runs independent blind tests against leading domestic and global competitors, and in the last three quarters alone logged five wins including Mamaearth's Rice Face Wash scoring 26 per cent higher likeability than a leading international brightness face wash, and BBlunt's Intense Moisture Shampoo scoring 2x on likeability versus a leading global haircare brand. Products are outsourced in manufacturing only; the formulations and brand narratives are entirely proprietary. This is precisely why gross margins hold at approximately 70 per cent, for every ₹100 of revenue, ₹70 remains after manufacturing costs, before marketing or overheads. Traditional FMCG companies with owned manufacturing typically run at 50-55 per cent gross margins. That 15-20 percentage point structural gap is Honasa's core financial advantage and it has held through FY24 (69.8 per cent), FY25 (70.3 per cent) and into Q3 FY26 (68.5 per cent), through channel turbulence, a full distribution reset and a near-halving of operating profits. Gross margin durability through adversity is perhaps the most reassuring signal in this entire story.

The Structural Tailwind

India's Beauty and Personal Care (BPC) market is valued at approximately USD 22 billion in 2024 and is projected to reach USD 34 billion by 2028 at an 11 per cent CAGR, roughly double the pace of the broader FMCG sector. The structural drivers are well understood: a median population age under 30, rising discretionary incomes, and a generational shift from commodity personal care to ingredient-led, premium-positioned products. What is less appreciated is how quickly this consumer has moved. A decade ago, most Indians bought whatever soap or shampoo their parents used. Today, consumers are actively researching Niacinamide concentrations, choosing between Kojic Acid and Vitamin C serums, and discovering brands entirely through 60-second Instagram content. BPC already accounts for 35 per cent of all online FMCG sales in India, a disproportionate share that reflects the category's natural affinity with digital discovery. Quick-commerce is creating an additional impulse-purchase layer that benefits brands with strong unaided consumer recall. Honasa's strategy is almost perfectly aligned with these tailwinds. The risk is that the same tailwind has attracted well-capitalised incumbents; HUL and Marico are both building premium digital-first sub-brands, while Nykaa and Sugar Cosmetics compete directly in skincare and cosmetics. Honasa's structural edge is not that it found the space first; it is that it has demonstrated an ability to build multiple brands simultaneously at speed, something large legacy organisations have historically struggled to execute.

The Brand Portfolio: One Company, Many Consumer Tribes

Honasa's multi-brand architecture is borrowed from the global FMCG playbook: no single brand can credibly serve every consumer cohort. A mother buying toxin-free baby wash, a 22-year-old targeting hyperpigmentation with actives, and a working professional looking for a simple men's sunscreen have entirely different purchase motivations. Honasa builds a distinct brand for each.

Brand	What It Does	Target Consumer	Current Status
Mamaearth	Natural, toxin-free personal care face wash, shampoo, baby care	Families, young millennials	Core anchor; back to double-digit growth
The Derma Co.	Actives-led, science-backed skincare serums, sunscreens, cleansers	Gen Z, skincare-aware consumers	Star performer; #1 sunscreen brand in India (Euromonitor); double-digit EBITDA
Aqualogica	Hydration-first skincare and SPF	Gen Z, Gen Alpha	On-plan; refresh underway ahead of summer
Dr. Sheth's	Premium dermatologist-formulated serums and skincare	Affluent, skincare-educated consumers	Scaling in premium actives
BBlunt	Professional hair care and colour at home	Urban women, salon-quality seekers	Relaunch underway; 2x blind-test winner vs. global brand
Staze	Colour cosmetics	Young women, make-up users	Crossed ₹50 crore ARR
Reginald Men	Men's sunscreen and grooming	Men, particularly South India	Newly acquired; most-searched men's sunscreen brand

The younger brands and everything outside Mamaearth are collectively growing at 25 per cent+ year-on-year, with The Derma Co. already at a double-digit EBITDA margin. CEO Varun Alagh, on the Q3 FY26 earnings call, articulated the long-term playbook clearly: keep Mamaearth as the mass-premium foundation, accelerate the younger brands towards ₹500 crore each, and continuously identify white spaces for the next build. It is a portfolio architecture that distributes both risk and growth; if one brand plateaus, three others are still in their compounding phase.

The 2024 Crash: A Distribution Sin, Not a Brand Problem

Between September and November 2024, Honasa's stock fell approximately 57 per cent, one of the sharpest drawdowns seen in a listed Indian consumer company in recent memory. Understanding precisely what broke and why it was a channel failure and not a brand failure is the most important analytical exercise for any investor evaluating this stock today. Honasa had been booking revenue as products moved into its general trade distribution network through a super-stockist layer. The primary sales numbers looked healthy. The problem was secondary sales, actual consumer offtake from retail shelves, were not keeping pace. Distributors were absorbing inventory that was not turning over at the rate the company's revenue recognition assumed. When the mismatch became impossible to paper over, management launched Project Neev, a fundamental restructuring of the entire General Trade (GT) model. The super-stockist layer was dismantled across the top 50 cities. Weaker distribution partners were replaced with higher-quality Tier-1 distributors. Honasa took back large volumes of unsold stock, recording sales returns of ₹63.52 crore in FY25 standalone accounts. The P&L impact was severe: EBITDA margins collapsed from 7.1 per cent to 3.3 per cent, and PAT fell 34 per cent for the full year. The critical distinction, and this is where the analytical work matters, is that underlying volume growth for FY25 still came in at 13.2 per cent. Consumer demand for Honasa's products never broke. Project Neev was a distribution surgery on an otherwise healthy body. The scar tissue today is inventory at a normalised 30 days, a cleaner secondary sales picture, and a GT network built for sustainable scale rather than short-term throughput.

Financials

The Q3 FY26 results are the clearest empirical evidence that Project Neev worked. Revenue hit ₹602 crore, the company's highest-ever quarterly figure, with EBITDA margin at 10.9 per cent, more than double the 5.0 per cent reported in the same quarter the prior year. PAT before exceptional items nearly doubled from ₹26 crore to ₹50 crore on underlying volume growth of 30.2 per cent.

Metric	Q3 FY25	Q3 FY26	Growth
Revenue from Operations	₹518 Cr.	₹602 Cr.	16.2% YoY
Gross Margin	70%	68.5%	Broadly stable
EBITDA Margin	5%	10.9%	590 bps
PAT	₹26 Cr.	₹50 Cr.	93% YoY
Volume Growth (UVG)	-	30.2%	Volume-led
Working Capital Days	Negative	-9 days	Healthy

The annual picture contextualises the transition. FY25 revenue grew a modest 7.7 per cent to ₹2,067 crore as Project Neev compressed both the top and bottom lines. But gross margins improved from 69.8 per cent to 70.3 per cent and working capital turned more negative, from –9 days in FY24 to –24 days in FY25. Negative working capital means the business collects from customers before paying suppliers; structurally, the company has never needed external debt to fund its growth, and that remained true even in its worst operating year.

Annual Performance - FY24 vs. FY25

Metric	FY 2023-24	FY 2024-25	Growth
Revenue from Operations	₹1,920 Cr.	₹2,067 Cr.	7.7%
Gross Margin	69.8%	70.3%	59 bps
EBITDA	137	68.5	-50%
EBITDA Margin	7.1%	3.3%	-382 bps
PAT	₹110.5 Cr.	₹72.7 Cr.	-34%
Volume Growth (UVG)	-	13.2%	Volume-led
Working Capital Days	-9 days	-24 days	More negative (better)

Growth Triggers

1. **Mamaearth Re-established in Double-digit Growth**- The flagship is back to teens growth driven by sharper formulations and Gen Z-targeted communication across six core categories. A stable, growing Mamaearth is the base on which the rest of the portfolio compounds; without it, the entire investment thesis weakens.
2. **The Derma Co.'s Offline Runway**- Already India's No. 1 online sunscreen brand operating at double-digit EBITDA margins, yet offline distribution remains at an early stage. Replicating offline what Mamaearth built over five years in general and modern trade represents a substantial revenue opportunity not yet priced into current numbers.
3. **Men's Skincare Early-mover Positioning**- Men's skincare searches have doubled, the category on quick commerce is growing over 100 per cent year-on-year, and male skincare influencers have grown 6x in five years. Reginald Men gives Honasa an early and credible position in a ₹20,000 crore market projected to nearly double by 2032.
4. **Margin Expansion as a Compounding Variable**- Management has guided approximately 100 basis points of EBITDA margin improvement annually for 2-3 years from marketing efficiency gains, payroll leverage and supply chain optimisation. At current revenue scale, 100 bps adds roughly ₹20-25 crore to annual operating profit, and as revenues grow, the absolute value of each improvement scales proportionally.

Risks: What the Bull Case Assumes Away

1. **Digital Marketing as Both Engine and Vulnerability**- Honasa's demand creation runs on social media, performance marketing and influencer content. A sustained rise in digital ad costs, platform algorithm changes or fading consumer trust in influencer-led discovery would directly impair customer acquisition economics, and there is no deep offline brand legacy to fall back on.
2. **No Manufacturing Ownership**- Asset-light works until it does not. A single quality failure at a contract manufacturer, a contamination incident, a supply disruption or a regulatory issue can damage brand equity that took years to build, with limited operational recourse.
3. **Incumbents Fighting Back**- HUL, Marico and well-capitalised global players are no longer conceding the digital and active-led space. They bring distribution depth and balance sheets Honasa cannot match. Being a disruptor is considerably harder when the companies being disrupted begin to disrupt back.

Valuation and Outlook

The numbers are no longer the concern. Margins are recovering, volumes are compounding and the distribution restructuring of FY25 is structurally behind the company. What the market is now debating is not whether Honasa is a good business, the evidence is clear that it is, but how much larger it can get from here. The longer-term picture is compelling. A portfolio of eight brands, a USD 34 billion market growing at 11 per cent annually, an offshore ambition still in early innings and a management team that has demonstrated it can both build and recover. The PEG of 1.5x and a Price-to-Sales of approximately 5x against a peer median of approximately 7.5x suggest the stock is not expensive relative to what the business can deliver; it is simply being asked to prove it can sustain the momentum. **HOLD**, the recovery has been validated, the growth runway is intact and the valuation leaves room for further re-rating as execution compounds. The next leg of the story belongs to investors willing to stay through the building phase.

Kerbside

The recommendations provided in this column are taken from various market sources such as brokers, analysts, dealers and investment strategists, etc. These recommendations may not be backed by strong fundamentals. Therefore we advise readers to use their own discretion before investing in these recommendation

POWERFUL RUN AHEAD

GE Power India
BSE Code: 532309
CMP: ₹556.10

GE Power India Limited, an established engineering and power-sector equipment company, is steadily reshaping its business profile. The company is engaged in engineering, procurement, manufacturing and servicing of power plants and related equipment, including boilers, turbines and pollution-control systems. The key shift lies in its focus on high-margin opportunities with shorter cash cycles and lower working capital requirements. At the same time, the company has been gradually scaling back from long-gestation projects, improving business stability over time. Institutional interest is also visible, with both FIIs and DIIs increasing their stake in the stock. Its core services business remains well placed to build on current momentum and deliver double-digit year-on-year growth again this year. Hence, watch out for this stock.

SUPER COOL GAINS

Amber Enterprises India Ltd
BSE Code: 540902
CMP: ₹8,107.80

Amber Enterprises India remains a leading manufacturer and solution provider for the room air-conditioner industry, with a market share of nearly 26-27 per cent. Its ability to manufacture around 70 per cent of RAC bill of materials gives it deeper control over the value chain. The bigger trigger, however, lies in electronics. Its PCBA, bare PCB and box-build businesses cater to consumer durables, smart electronics, automotive, telecom, healthcare, industrial and defence segments. This division has emerged as a key growth engine, with margins expected to move into double digits by FY27. Despite raw material headwinds, Q3 margins remained healthy. If execution holds, operating leverage could drive stronger earnings growth.

WIRED FOR THE T&D BOOM

CG Power and Industrial Solutions Ltd
BSE Code: 500093
CMP: ₹820.40

CG Power and Industrial Solutions, part of the Murugappa Group, is a leading engineering company focused on electrical energy management. The company is well placed as India's transmission and distribution sector emerges as a strong industrial growth theme, backed by a large domestic investment pipeline and rising global demand for power equipment. With its existing capabilities and planned capacity expansion, CG Power is positioned to benefit from the expanding transmission opportunity. It also remains a leader in the low-tension motor market, while its ramp-up in high-tension motors could add another growth lever as industrial demand recovers. In short, CG Power looks firmly wired to India's power infrastructure growth story.

SOMETHING BREWING

CESC
BSE Code: 500084
CMP: ₹188.15

CESC, the flagship company of the RP-Sanjiv Goenka Group, is a vertically integrated power utility with presence across electricity generation and distribution. The stock has recently started drawing attention on the Street, with market chatter suggesting that select HNIs may be accumulating it. The recent spike in volumes has added fuel to the buzz. Such movement often makes investors sit up and track whether a larger development is taking shape behind the scenes. For now, the story remains in the "market murmur" zone, but the volume footprint is hard to ignore. If the chatter turns into news, CESC could see stronger action ahead. Keep it firmly on the radar.

(Closing price as of April 27, 2026)

MUTUAL FUND *UNLOCKED*

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SIFs: The Middle Path Needs a Careful Walk

I have been closely following the Indian mutual fund industry for the last 25 years. I have witnessed numerous product innovations, some truly enriching investor choices while others merely added layers of complexity. Specialised Investment Funds (SIFs) have arrived at a significant moment in India's wealth creation journey. Today's affluent investors are no longer satisfied with plain-vanilla mutual funds, yet many remain hesitant to enter the high-ticket and relatively less transparent world of Portfolio Management Services (PMS) and Alternative Investment Funds (AIFs). SIFs aim to fill this important gap by offering a well-regulated middle path.

Our cover story this issue aptly describes SIFs as 'the third path' between mass-market mutual funds and high-end PMS/AIF structures. The early traction is encouraging. Within just six months of launch, SIFs have attracted over 40,000 investors and gathered ₹10,620 crore in assets under management as of March 2026. However, nearly 75 per cent of this AUM is concentrated in hybrid long-short funds, indicating that the category is still evolving and has not yet become a broad-based offering.

This early momentum, however, should not be mistaken for automatic suitability. In my long experience, SIFs are not a shortcut to higher returns. These are strategy-led products whose performance will depend heavily on the fund manager's skill, disciplined use of derivatives, effective liquidity management, and strong risk controls. I firmly believe SIFs are not meant for new or novice investors. They are best positioned as sophisticated asset allocation tools rather than pure return-enhancement vehicles.

The core message for investors is one of clarity and caution. SIFs can become a valuable innovation in India's wealth market, but only if approached with proper understanding. They can be useful for experienced investors seeking a tactical allocation. However, chasing them merely for their sophisticated appeal carries a clear risk, complexity without understanding can quickly turn into an expensive mistake.

As always, our endeavour remains to help you navigate these emerging opportunities with eyes wide open. Proceed with knowledge, not just curiosity.

Shashikant

Shashikant Singh
Executive Editor

Understanding FoFs

The recent story on international mutual funds was very insightful. However, I'm not familiar with the 'FoF category' mentioned in the table. Could you please explain what it means?

- Ritu Sharma

Editor Responds : A Fund of Funds (FoF) is a mutual fund that invests in other mutual fund schemes rather than directly in stocks or bonds. In the context of international investing, FoFs typically invest in overseas mutual funds or ETFs, giving investors exposure to global markets without needing a foreign trading account. One key advantage is convenience and diversification, as professional fund managers select and manage the underlying funds.

However, FoFs may involve an additional layer of costs, since investors indirectly bear the expenses of both the FoF and the underlying fund. Hence, while FoFs can be a useful addition to your portfolio, their allocation should be limited.

Content

SIFs: The Third Path

Specialised Investment Funds are SEBI's answer to a long-ignored gap in India's investment landscape. Positioned between mutual funds and high-ticket PMS or AIF products, SIFs promise greater flexibility, tighter regulation, and access to more sophisticated strategies. But are they a genuine breakthrough for affluent investors, or simply a polished new wrapper for old complexity?

India's capital market regulator has quietly unveiled a new investment category designed to sit between the mass-market efficiency of mutual funds and the opacity of private wealth management. Specialised Investment Funds (SIFs), a framework SEBI formalised in 2025, are meant to serve a specific cohort: affluent investors hungry for exotic strategies but wary of the ₹50 lakh minimums, complex fee structures, and regulatory ambiguity that still characterise Portfolio Management Services (PMS) and Alternative Investment Funds (AIFs).

The question investors face now is whether SIFs represent genuine innovation or merely regulatory window-dressing for products that already exist.

A Widening Appetite, a Narrowing Path

It started with a growing sense of frustration among many investors. Across the country, a familiar dilemma now plays out among high-net-worth individuals, business owners, experienced traders, and small-time entrepreneurs who have built wealth. They are left choosing between two imperfect options from their perspective.

On one side are mutual funds, mass-market products bound by fund mandates, limited flexibility, and largely conventional strategies such as large-cap equities, government securities, or standard balanced funds. On the other side lie PMS and Alternative Investment Funds (AIFs), more tailored and sophisticated, but often complex, less transparent, and typically accessible only with a minimum investment of ₹50 lakh or more.

That gap, the missing middle, has been widening for years. And for the first time in India's investment architecture, a regulator appears to be acting on it. In 2025, the Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) formalised the framework for SIFs, a new category that occupies a deliberate middle position. SIFs are stricter and more transparent than AIFs or PMS offerings. They are more flexible and strategy-rich than mutual funds. They target accredited investors willing to embrace complexity in exchange for access to strategies, long-short equities, tactical asset allocation, derivatives strategies, structured products, that the retail-focused mutual fund regime simply does not permit.

Whether SIFs will become a durable, valuable investment category or merely a marketing artefact of Indian financial engineering remains genuinely uncertain at the current juncture. But their emergence signals something clearer: the Indian investment landscape, long dominated by the mass-market efficiency of fund houses and the boutique opacity of private wealth managers, is getting a new category. The affluent middle-class, educated, globally aware investor, increasingly sceptical of traditional gatekeeping, is demanding a third path. And for the first time, regulators are attempting to build one, complete with guardrails.

The Gap That Nobody Wanted to Acknowledge

To understand why SIFs exist, you first have to understand what was missing. The Indian investment industry, for nearly three decades, has been shaped by two distinct ecosystems operating in parallel, almost in denial of one another.

On one side: mutual funds. Regulated to the hilt, transparent to the point of prescription, available to anyone even with ₹500 to invest and a KYC form. Mutual funds, whether equity, debt, or balanced, operate under SEBI's strict mandate. Their portfolios are disclosed. Their fees are capped. Their strategies are defined narrowly: fund managers operate within defined investment universes. A large-cap equity fund manager cannot suddenly short stocks or deploy leverage. Structure matters more than skill.

On the other hand, PMS and AIFs operate in a different league altogether. They offer far greater flexibility compared to mutual funds, but are still regulated by the SEBI.
A PMS manager can take concentrated positions, move between asset classes, and adjust strategy dynamically based on conviction. However, this flexibility is not entirely unrestricted, there are regulatory and mandate-level boundaries in place.

Access, however, is tightly gatekept. PMS mandates a minimum investment of ₹50 lakh (as per SEBI regulations), though in practice, meaningful participation often starts upwards of ₹2–5 crore depending on the strategy and manager.

AIFs, being pooled vehicles, also require a minimum investment of ₹1 crore per investor (₹25 lakh for employees/directors), making them largely accessible to HNIs and institutional investors. Both PMS and AIFs offer limited transparency compared to mutual funds, disclosures are periodic rather than frequent, fee structures can vary, and strategies are typically shared in detail only with enrolled investors.

What existed in between? Nothing. An investor with ₹10 lakh who wanted something more sophisticated than a mutual fund but was not yet ready for PMS indeterminacy had no legitimate, regulated home. Someone with a higher investable sum moved to AIFs anyway, overpaying on fees. Some settled for mutual funds despite chafing at constraints. Others experimented with unlisted securities or direct equity, paths that minimised regulatory oversight but maximised personal risk.

This was not just a product gap. It was a signal of market segmentation that the regulator had never formally acknowledged. SEBI built mutual funds for the masses and PMS/AIFs for the elite. The Indian wealth managers in between, the accomplished investors who wanted both flexibility and structure, who could understand complexity but valued transparency, had nowhere to go.

The Architecture of SIFs: What They Are and What They Are Not

On paper, SIFs are defined narrowly. They are pooled investment vehicles, closer in structure to mutual funds than to AIFs, but designed to offer greater strategy flexibility. They can pursue a wider range of investment strategies than traditional mutual funds, including the use of derivatives, limited short-selling, and more concentrated positions.

However, they are not lightly regulated. SEBI's framework prescribes detailed disclosure norms, clearly defined strategy buckets, fee caps (stricter than AIFs but more flexible than mutual funds), and investor suitability requirements.

SIFs are intended for relatively sophisticated investors, but not strictly limited to accredited investors. High-net-worth individuals are the primary target segment. Minimum investment thresholds is higher than mutual funds, typically starting around ₹10 lakh and going upwards depending on the strategy and structure.

Permitted SIF strategies in India broadly include SEBI-defined equity, debt and hybrid long-short structures, such as Equity Long-Short, Debt Long-Short, Sector Rotation Long-Short, Sectoral Debt Long-Short, Active Asset Allocator Long-Short and Hybrid Long-Short. These can use exchange-traded derivatives for hedging, rebalancing and limited unhedged short exposure. However, the framework remains tightly controlled: unhedged short exposure is capped at 25 per cent of net assets, cumulative gross exposure is generally capped at 100 per cent of net assets, and investments in unlisted or privately placed instruments remain subject to applicable SEBI mutual fund/SIF rules, disclosures and portfolio limits.

In India, SIFs are best understood not as a loose bucket of 'concentrated' or 'derivatives-led' products, but as a tightly regulated set of SEBI-recognised long-short strategies across equity, debt and hybrid formats. The current framework gives fund managers more room than traditional mutual funds to express tactical views while still operating within defined

Comprehensive Study Guide: Specialized Investment Funds (SIF) in India

An SIF is a SEBI-regulated investment category designed to bridge the gap between retail mutual funds and high-ticket Alternative Investment Funds (AIFs) or Portfolio Management Services (PMS). It allows for more sophisticated, flexible strategies, such as long-short positions, targeted at experienced investors with a higher risk appetite. The Minimum Investment Threshold requires an aggregate investment of not less than ₹10 lakh per investor across all strategies offered by an SIF at the PAN level. This threshold is mandatory for general investors but does not apply to 'Accredited Investors'.

While traditional mutual funds primarily use derivatives for hedging and rebalancing, SIFs are permitted to take unhedged derivative exposure. Specifically, SIFs can allocate up to 25 per cent of their net assets to exchange-traded derivative instruments for tactical purposes other than hedging. To provide investors with an exit option, SEBI mandates that units of all close-ended and interval investment strategies of SIFs must be listed on recognised stock exchanges. The subscription and redemption frequencies for these units must be clearly disclosed in the fund's offer documents.

Distributors must pass the National Institute of Securities Markets (NISM) Series-XIII: Common Derivatives Certification Examination. This ensures that those selling SIF products understand the complex derivative-based strategies often employed by these funds. Equity Long-Short SIFs have demonstrated greater resilience than the broader market. This outperformance is attributed to their ability to take short positions that cushion the downside during market corrections.

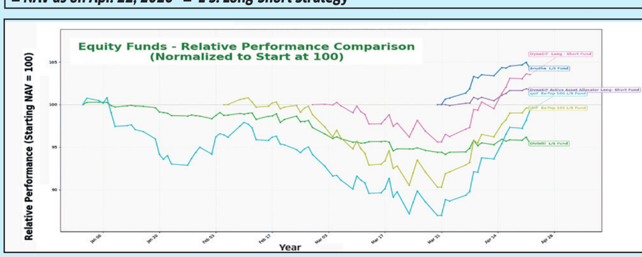
For investment strategies that do not offer daily redemptions, AMCs have the authority to implement a notice period. This notice period is designed to help manage liquidity and can have a maximum duration of 15 working days. SIFs use a pictorial 'Risk-band' with five distinct levels to depict potential risk, similar to the risk-o-meter used in mutual funds. This risk-band is evaluated monthly and must be disclosed on the AMC and AMFI websites, with any changes communicated to unitholders.

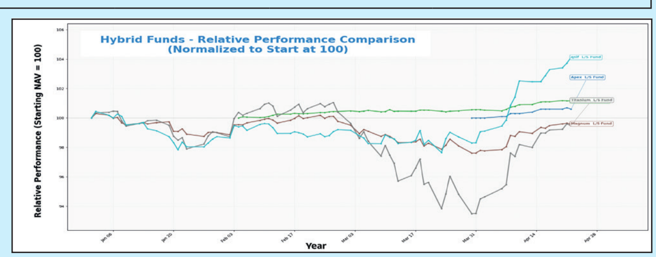
Term	Definition
Accredited Investor	A category of investors who, due to their financial status or expertise, are exempt from the minimum INR 10 lakh investment threshold for SIFs.
Active Asset Allocator	A hybrid SIF strategy that dynamically moves capital between different asset classes based on market conditions to optimize returns.
AMC (Asset Management Company)	The entity responsible for managing the investments of a mutual fund or SIF and ensuring regulatory compliance.
Compliance Test Report (CTR)	A regulatory filing for AMCs; for SIFs, this includes a specific "Part IV" covering minimum thresholds, derivative limits, and strategy compliance.
Derivative Exposure	The total value of a fund's positions in financial contracts like futures and options; SIFs can have unhedged exposure up to 25% of net assets.
Equity Ex-Top 100	An investment strategy focusing on stocks outside the top 100 largest companies by market capitalization, often utilizing long-short techniques.
Long-Short Strategy	An investment approach that involves buying assets expected to increase in value (long) and selling assets expected to decrease in value (short).
Minimum Investment Threshold	The SEBI-mandated minimum of INR 10 lakh that a non-accredited investor must maintain across SIF strategies at the PAN level.

FUND PERFORMANCE SUMMARY (Sorted by Returns - Best to Worst)

Fund Name	Start Date	NAV* (₹)	Return (%)	AMC	Category
Arudha Equity Long-Short Fund	Mar. 30, 2026	10.24	4.23	Bandhan	Equity L-S
qsif Hybrid Long-Short Fund	Jan. 1, 2026	10.43	4.12	Quant	Equity L-S
DynaSIF Equity Long - Short Fund	Feb. 27, 2026	10.36	3.53	360 ONE	Equity L-S
Altiva Hybrid Long-Short Fund	Jan. 1, 2026	10.53	2.20	Edelweiss	Hybrid L-S
DynaSIF Active Asset Allocator Long- Short Fund	Mar. 30, 2026	10.19	1.72	360 ONE	Multi-Asset
Arudha Hybrid Long-Short Fund	Feb. 4, 2026	10.15	1.16	Bandhan	Hybrid L-S
iSIF Hybrid Long-Short Fund	Feb. 5, 2026	10.11	0.89	ICICI Pru.	Hybrid L-S
Apex Hybrid Long-Short Fund	Mar. 30, 2026	10.08	0.60	ABSLMF	Hybrid L-S
Magnum Hybrid Long Short Fund	Jan. 1, 2026	10.20	-0.40	SBI	Hybrid L-S
iSIF Equity Ex-Top 100 Long-Short Fund	Feb. 5, 2026	9.95	-0.40	ICICI Pru.	Ex-Top 100 L-S
Titanium Hybrid Long-Short Fund	Jan. 1, 2026	10.01	-0.52	Tata	Hybrid L-S
qsif Equity Ex-Top 100 Long-Short Fund	Jan. 1, 2026	9.83	-0.64	Quant	Equity L-S
qsif Equity Long Short Fund	Jan. 1, 2026	10.02	-0.89	Quant	Equity L-S
Diviniti Equity Long Short Fund	Jan. 1, 2026	958.75	-4.58	ITI MF	Equity L-S

■ NAV as on Apr. 22, 2026 ■ L-S: Long-Short Strategy





regulatory boundaries.

Costs, too, sit in a middle zone: SIFs follow a mutual-fund-style total expense ratio framework rather than an open-ended performance-fee model, with TER limits linked to AUM slabs. Liquidity is also more structured than many assume, with launched open-ended strategies offering dealing on business days rather than the long lock-ins associated with many AIFs. At the same time, disclosure standards remain robust, with daily NAV publication, regular portfolio disclosures, dashboard-based reporting and half-yearly financial updates forming part of the framework. Fees are an important differentiator.

Liquidity also sits in the middle. Unlike mutual funds, which offer daily liquidity, SIFs are likely to offer periodic liquidity (monthly, quarterly, or longer intervals), but generally more frequent than traditional AIF lock-ins.

On transparency, SIFs are expected to maintain higher disclosure standards than AIFs, including periodic fact sheets, portfolio disclosures, and clear fee reporting, while still allowing more flexibility than mutual funds.

Why Now? The Regulatory Calculus

SEBI's intervention was no mere coincidence, several key factors were at play. Wealth redistribution in India is accelerating, with the number of individuals holding between ₹5 crore and ₹50 crore increasing sharply. This group includes early tech startup winners, those benefiting from real estate appreciation, successful pharma enterprises, and thriving tradeable businesses. As of 2024, around 3.8 lakh HNWIs (High-Net-Worth Individuals, investable assets of USD 1 million or more), which has increased steadily in the last few years, exist in India, many of whom are more globally aware and increasingly sceptical of traditional financial gatekeepers. These individuals are less inclined to settle for the limitations of mutual funds or the opacity of private wealth management. Instead, they are actively seeking alternative avenues, moving their money towards international managers, complex investment strategies, or, unfortunately, exploitative schemes.

Second, the financial services industry has been evolving rapidly. Independent registered investment advisors have proliferated, offering advisory on diverse strategies. Fintech platforms have democratised market access. International investors have brought expectations for regulatory transparency, operational sophistication, and strategic flexibility that the old binary, mutual funds or opaque private wealth, could not meet. The market was fragmenting, and regulatory arbitrage was increasing.

Third, SEBI understood a broader imperative: if the Indian middle-affluent segment could not find a regulated, transparent home for sophisticated strategies, money would flow to unregulated spaces, overseas platforms, dubious AIFs, direct stock trading that masqueraded as strategy. By creating SIFs, SEBI was not merely accommodating demand; it was capturing it within a regulatory perimeter where suitability, transparency, and accountability could be enforced.

This was sophisticated regulatory thinking. SIFs are not the same as mutual funds because they cannot be. Affluent investors need flexibility. But unlike AIFs, which have historically operated with minimal transparency and maximum discretion, SIFs came with teeth. The regulator insisted on fact sheets, performance disclosures, clear fee schedules, and documented investor suitability. The trade-off: managers got latitude to pursue sophisticated strategies; investors got assurance that operators would not disappear into operational opaqueness.

The Opportunity: Real or Illusory?

For investors, the theoretical case for SIFs is compelling. The access argument alone is significant: sophisticated strategies that once required ₹10–25 crore commitments and endured six-month lock-ins are now available at much lower thresholds, with more frequent liquidity. This is a true democratisation of investment opportunities.

Consider the appeal of a long-short equity SIF in a volatile market. A traditional mutual fund manager, constrained to net long positions, is structurally vulnerable in downturns. A SIF manager can maintain long exposure to conviction picks while hedging tail risk through shorts. In a ₹15 crore investment, that flexibility, the ability to navigate both bull and bear markets through tactical positioning rather than forced buy-and-hold, has non-trivial value.

Consider the case of the Diviniti Equity Long-Short Fund offered by ITI AMC, launched in December 2025, which has generated a negative return of 3.82 per cent since the start of the year. In the same period, Nifty 500 has generated negative return of 6.81 per cent. This shows outperformance or alpha of around three per cent. Similar is the case with Hybrid funds. For example, qsif Hybrid Long-Short Fund, sponsored by ICICI Pru. AMC, has generated return of around 3.71 per cent since the start of the year compared to negative returns generated by most of the Hybrid category in the same period.

Another benefit of SIF is the tax dimension. In the case of equity mutual funds, long-term capital gains apply after a holding period of one year, currently taxed at 12.5 per cent on gains above ₹1.25 lakh annually. While there is no explicit regulatory cap on portfolio turnover in mutual funds, the structure of open-ended schemes and associated disclosure expectations tend to discourage highly tactical, high-frequency positioning.

A SIF manager, on the other hand, while still operating within SEBI's regulatory perimeter, is likely to enjoy greater flexibility in portfolio construction. This opens the door to more dynamic approaches such as tax-loss harvesting, opportunistic rebalancing, and staggered profit booking. In theory, such tools could improve post-tax efficiency. In practice, however, whether these advantages meaningfully translate into superior net returns, once higher fees and execution complexity are accounted for, remains an open, empirical question. Since SIF has yet to complete its one year, this needs to be watched if this investment instrument generates better returns.

The portfolio construction case for high-net-worth individuals is equally compelling. Consider a household managing ₹50 crore in investable assets. The allocation may already span domestic equity via mutual funds, international exposure through global funds, debt through fixed income instruments, and real estate as a long-duration asset class. Within this framework, a long-short SIF can serve as a satellite allocation, perhaps a ₹5 crore tactical sleeve aimed at thematic bets, concentrated conviction ideas, or hedged multi-asset strategies that would typically be difficult to accommodate within the constraints of traditional mutual fund mandates.

For asset management firms as well, the opportunity set is becoming increasingly visible. Many established fund houses have long been constrained by the product architecture of mutual funds, even as investor sophistication has evolved. A ₹5,000 crore AUM manager may already operate PMS and AIF strategies, but those channels often remain niche, constrained by distribution reach and a predominantly ultra-HNI focus. SIFs, in contrast, offer a potential bridge into the mass affluent and upper retail segments, without the steep brand and distribution intensity required for PMS scaling.

The Risks: Complexity, Suitability, and Disappointment

But the risks rise in proportion to the sophistication of the product.

- **The first is a complexity-versus-suitability risk.** A SIF built around long-short equity strategies and derivative overlays is fundamentally different from a plain-vanilla index mutual fund or actively managed mutual fund schemes. It demands genuine investor understanding of leverage, hedging, short-selling and the ways volatility can magnify both gains and losses. That is where the gap emerges: the accreditation framework is primarily a financial filter, not a test of investment literacy. An investor may qualify on paper and still lack the experience required to assess the strategy properly. A business owner with substantial wealth tied up in real estate, for example, may meet the eligibility threshold yet still be exposed to confusion, expectation mismatch and poor product fit.

- **Second is the mis-selling risk.** In mutual fund distribution, we have seen instances of AMCs incentivising agents to sell unsuitable products, churning portfolios, and masking fee opacity through complexity. The SIF category, being newer, offers a fresh field for these patterns. A distributor selling a concentrated equity SIF to an investor who believed they were buying a diversified fund, or selling a leveraged strategy to someone unfamiliar with forced liquidations in volatile markets, is a foreseeable outcome. SEBI has outlined suitability norms, advisors must certify investor understanding, but enforcement remains a question.

- **Third is the performance risk, which is peculiar to active, concentrated strategies.** A long-short SIF delivered by a talented manager during a stable bull market may appear to justify its expense ratio. But a downturn, or even a period of mean reversion, can expose whether the manager's outperformance was skill or luck. The more concentrated a fund (as many early SIFs are), the more volatile performance becomes. An investor comfortable with a mutual fund's 10-15 per cent annual swings may find a concentrated SIF's 20-30 per cent volatility psychologically unsustainable, leading to forced redemptions at precisely the wrong moment.

- **Fourth is product proliferation risk.** The SIF category is new enough that fund houses will inevitably experiment, launching SIFs in niche strategies with limited manager experience, or SIFs pursuing themes (AI, fintech, biotech) in which the Indian investment universe is too small to support meaningful diversification. A ₹200 crore SIF betting on 'digital infrastructure' in India may sound opportunistic; in reality, it may be dangerously concentrated. As the category grows, weaker offerings will proliferate faster than regulatory scrutiny can realistically catch them.

- **Finally, there is the danger of false sophistication.** An affluent investor with limited market experience can mistake 'more complex' for 'better'. A SIF claiming to deploy derivatives strategies and market-neutral positioning may feel like a superior product to a simple equity mutual fund. But complexity itself is not an advantage. A fund charging 2.5 per cent annually while underperforming a 0.5 per cent index mutual fund by 3-4 per cent has merely created a fee drag, regardless of its strategic sophistication. The investor's job is to ask whether the complexity is earning its cost. The honest answer, for many offerings, will be no.

The Real Test: Market Behaviour

Early adoption patterns in Specialised Investment Funds are beginning to offer meaningful signals, but the story is best told with the timeline set right. SIFs were introduced under SEBI's framework on February 27, 2025, with the regime taking effect from April 1, 2025, and the first strategies entering the market only in October 2025. From there, the trajectory has been encouraging: SIF assets stood at about ₹2,010 crore in October 2025, rose to ₹4,892 crore by December 2025, and climbed further to ₹9,711 crore in February 2026, before reaching ₹10,620 crore in March 2026. That is a healthy start for a new category, but it also underlines how early the journey still is.

Against India's mutual fund industry, which managed ₹65.74 lakh crore in March 2025 and ₹73.73 lakh crore in March 2026, SIFs remain a niche segment for now, more notable for their strategic promise than for their current scale.

Distribution patterns are already revealing the shape of the SIF market, but the picture is more nuanced than a simple institutional-versus-retail divide. At this stage, SIFs are clearly being built through specialist channels rather than broad-based mass distribution. The category carries a ₹10 lakh minimum investment threshold, SEBI has required SIFs to maintain branding distinct from regular mutual funds, and AMFI has created a separate SIF distributor registration framework that requires additional certification and AMC empanelment. That naturally tilts early distribution towards advisors, wealth platforms, and better-equipped intermediary networks.

Even so, it would be too strong to say SIFs are largely absent from the traditional mutual fund distribution ecosystem, because AMFI has explicitly opened the route for mutual fund distributors to register for SIF distribution, and retail-facing access has also started to expand, with FYERS positioning itself in October 2025 as the first stockbroking platform to offer SIFs to retail investors.

That creates a double-edged starting point for the category. On the one hand, specialist gating can help reduce the risk of casual mis-selling of products that are structurally more complex than conventional mutual funds. On the other hand, this remains a formative phase for the advisory ecosystem itself, because the additional derivatives-oriented certification requirement has acted as a real bottleneck in scaling distribution. Performance, meanwhile, is still too early to judge with confidence. The first SIF strategies were launched only in October 2025, and by March 2026, the category had grown to 14 schemes with assets of ₹10,620 crore, leaving investors with only a short live track record to assess. Early outcomes have been mixed rather than uniform, with hybrid long-short strategies showing greater resilience in the recent correction while returns across equity-oriented strategies have varied more widely. That, in turn, reinforces the central reality of SIF investing, manager selection matters immensely. In this segment, investors are not merely buying market exposure; they are underwriting a manager's process, risk controls, and ability to use shorting, derivatives, and tactical allocation with discipline.

What Smart Investors Should Take Away

SIFs fill a genuine gap. Mass affluent investors seeking sophisticated strategies have long been underserved. While backed by a sound regulatory framework and transparent fees, SIFs are not automatically suitable for every investor.

Consider SIFs if: You have ₹50 lakh or more in investable assets and genuinely understand the strategy you are backing. You have the temperament to hold volatile, concentrated positions for multiple years without panic selling. You are seeking true portfolio diversification, adding something genuinely different from your core equity and debt holdings. You want tactical positioning in specific market conditions, long-short hedging in expensive equity markets, for instance, but not a permanent bet. And critically, you believe the manager's skill and process are worth the additional 1-2 per cent in annual fees relative to a passive equivalent.

Avoid SIFs if: You are being sold them by a distributor who may be motivated by higher commissions, without adequate explanation of strategy mechanics. You cannot articulate precisely what the fund is doing and why it differs meaningfully from alternatives. You expect SIFs to reliably outperform markets because they are 'more sophisticated'. You would panic sell if the fund declined 25 per cent in a market downturn, or become euphoric if it jumped 30 per cent in a bull run. You are drawn to a SIF primarily because it feels like an 'insider' or 'advanced' product—that is precisely the inverse of sound investing.

Before investing, ask these questions: What precisely is the fund's strategy, and do you understand it fully? What is the track record of this specific manager in this specific strategy, not just the firm's overall performance? What is the liquidity structure if you need to exit early? Who exactly is making investment decisions, one manager or a team?

The larger question SIFs raise is whether regulated, transparent, sophisticated investing can scale in India without the gatekeeping and opacity of traditional private wealth management. The early evidence suggests yes, but the category is still evolving. Over the next 2-3 years, several things will matter: whether the early SIF launches deliver on their return promises, or whether performance volatility exposes them as unnecessarily complex; whether mis-selling becomes rampant, triggering regulatory crackdowns; whether the investor base becomes more sophisticated in SIF selection or remains vulnerable to marketing; and whether SEBI maintains transparent, consistent oversight or allows the category to drift towards the opacity that has long characterised AIFs.

For now, SIFs are what they claim: a middle path. They are neither revolutionary nor merely cosmetic. They fill a gap and offer access that did not previously exist. But access without understanding is dangerous. An affluent investor is not automatically sophisticated. Complexity should never be mistaken for quality. The investor's job remains unchanged: to know what you own, to understand why you own it, and to demand that the returns you receive justify the complexity and cost you are bearing.

SIFs work for investors who approach them with that discipline. They are a trap for those who treat them as badges of financial sophistication. Which category you fall into will determine whether the new category becomes, for you, an advantage or merely an expensive detour.

ICICI Prudential Energy Opportunities Fund Direct-Growth

Scheme Category	Equity: Thematic-Energy
5-Year Median Rolling Returns (Since Inception)	9.97% p.a.
AUM (₹ Cr.) Mar 31, 2026	8,796
NAV (₹) Apr 27, 2026	11.85
Expense Ratio (%) Mar. 30, 2026	0.61%
Benchmark	NIFTY Energy TRI
Exit Load	1% if redeemed within 3 months.
Fund Managers	Nitya Mishra

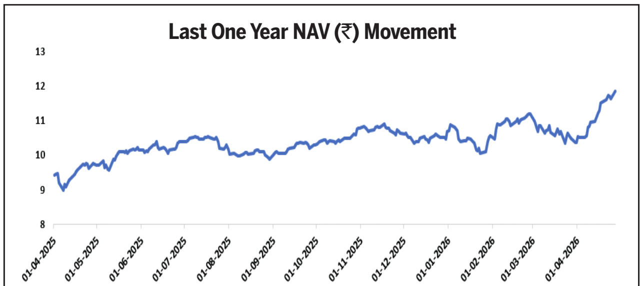
Reason for recommendation

Energy stocks can work as a satellite allocation because they have shown relative strength when the broader equity market has remained under pressure. In the last few quarters, while equities have corrected, the energy sector has delivered better returns, offering diversification beyond equity funds. ICICI Prudential Energy Opportunities Fund captures this theme. Over one month, the fund delivered 10.79 per cent, ahead of the category average of 10.17 per cent, an outperformance of 0.62 percentage points. The gap widened over three months, with the fund generating 14.80 per cent against the category average of 10.71 per cent, beating it by 4.09 percentage points. Over six months, the fund returned 9.20 per cent versus 5.82 per cent for the category, an excess return of 3.38 percentage points. On a one-year basis, it delivered 17.89 per cent compared with the category average of 13.23 per cent, outperforming by 4.66 percentage points. This consistency indicates participation in sector momentum. The portfolio is tilted towards energy, as the name suggests, forming 56.54 per cent of the allocation, making it a focused thematic play. Capital goods follows with 20.52 per cent, adding exposure to companies that may benefit from power, infrastructure and energy transition spending. Construction accounts for 5.45 per cent, materials 4.63 per cent and financials 3.43 per cent, giving supporting diversification while keeping the main story energy-driven.

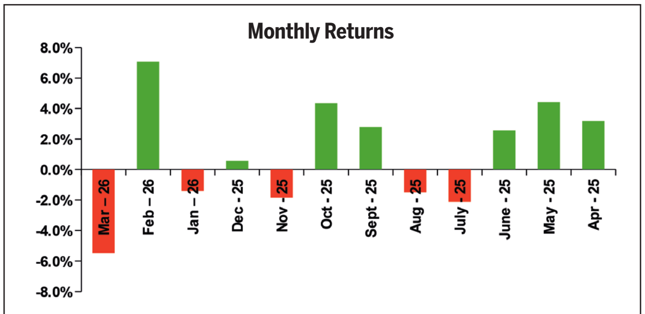
Among the top holdings, Reliance Industries leads with 9.06 per cent, followed by NTPC at 8.97 per cent and ONGC at 7.32 per cent. Tata Power and Indian Oil Corporation contribute 3.74 per cent and 3.62 per cent, respectively.Overall, the fund suits investors seeking satellite exposure to India's energy theme. Recent outperformance, focused allocation and strong large-cap holdings make it suitable for investors with a higher risk appetite and a medium-to-long-term view. It should complement, not replace, a core diversified equity portfolio.

Top Holdings

COMPANY NAME	% TO NET ASSETS
Reliance Industries Ltd.	9.06
NTPC Ltd.	8.97
Oil And Natural Gas Corporation Ltd.	7.32
Tata Power Company Ltd.	3.74
Indian Oil Corporation Ltd.	3.62
Bharat Petroleum Corporation Ltd.	2.88
Power Grid Corporation Of India Ltd.	2.82
Coal India Ltd.	2.80
Bharat Heavy Electricals Ltd.	2.34
Kalpataru Projects International Ltd.	2.04



The NAV graph is for the period of trailing one year.



Why Crises Create the Biggest Wealth

M K Balaji

Co - Founder & Chief Business Officer

First Principles Asset Services LLP.

As the world enters yet another week of the ongoing Iran-Israel-US conflict, headlines remain fixated on geopolitics, but the real impact is being felt closer home in India.

For India, the connection is structural. India relies heavily on imports from this region to meet a large part of its energy needs. When tensions rise, crude oil prices tend to spike. This affects fuel costs and causes a ripple effect through the economy, putting pressure on the currency, increasing inflation, and tightening financial conditions. Markets know this script well and typically react before the full impact is visible.

A Reset Disguised as a Fall- Over the past 18 months, Indian equities were going through a time correction. Markets were not falling sharply, but they were digesting earlier excesses. Valuations were cooling gradually. That phase has now shifted to a clearer price correction. The headline numbers tell part of the story. The Nifty50 is roughly 15 per cent below its peak. Small-caps are down 24 per cent, and micro-caps have slid close to 29 per cent. Beneath the index-level calm, there is a deeper churn. Nearly half the listed universe has corrected far more than the headline indices suggest.

Overvaluation is being corrected. Over-hyped stories, fragile balance sheets, and optimism built on thin air are being pulled back to reality. The market is redrawing the line between perception and performance. Yet, in the middle of this correction, something more nuanced is unfolding. Strong, fundamentally sound businesses are also getting dragged down alongside the obvious laggards.

Corrections like this are broad-based. Prices fall across the market, and even quality companies can temporarily trade below their true value. For long-term investors, this gap between price and value is where opportunities emerge. The gap that emerges between value and price is not always visible immediately, but it is precisely where long-term opportunities are created.

When Prices Fall, But Businesses Don't- Here is the paradox most investors miss: markets can fall even when businesses improve.

Corporate India, away from the noise, has been quietly getting its house in order. Revenue growth, which once limped below 5 per cent, is now closer to 10 per cent. Operating leverage is beginning to play out, allowing incremental growth to translate more efficiently into profitability. Balance sheets remain resilient and healthier than in previous cycles.

This creates a rare divergence. Prices are falling, yet earnings power is improving. Such phases do not appear frequently, but when they do, they tend to reward investors who recognise them early. What the market is effectively doing is embedding future potential into current valuations. In other words, the next phase of returns is being seeded in the present, even if it is not immediately visible.

The Trap of Waiting- Crisis investing sounds simple. Buy when others are fearful. Stay patient. Think long term. In reality, it feels like trying to catch a falling knife in the dark. The news cycle is relentlessly negative. Sentiment remains unpredictable. Every instinct tells you to wait. Wait for stability, for clarity, for 'things to settle'. But markets have a habit of moving ahead of comfort.

By the time the headlines soften and consensus turns optimistic again, prices have already adjusted. The easy money, the kind that comes from buying mispriced assets, tends to disappear just when it starts feeling safe to invest. A crisis is a window of opportunity, and windows do not stay open forever.

Uncomfortable Bets, Extraordinary Outcomes- This phase is not about timing the bottom; something even experienced investors struggle to do. It is about disciplined participation. Gradually accumulate quality businesses. Focus on earnings, not noise. Accept volatility as part of long-term compounding. Crises reset markets, reprice risk, and create better entry points. Most importantly, they offer a chance to invest in the future at more reasonable valuations, but only for those willing to act despite the discomfort.

The Cost of Doing Nothing- Investors fear losses in a downturn. But a bigger mistake is doing nothing. Staying on the sidelines may feel safe, but it often means missing the early stages of the next growth cycle. In investing, crises rarely destroy wealth on their own. Ignoring them does. The next set of winners is usually built during uncertain phases like this, not in times of comfort. The future will not favour those who wait for reassurance, but those who act despite the discomfort. Because when markets recover, they do not wait for everyone to be ready.

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Make Your MF Portfolio More Effective

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Mutual funds have begun to find their rightful place in the portfolios of an ever-increasing number of investors in our country, especially those who have adopted SIP as a mechanism to achieve their investment goals. They are gradually waking up to the inherent advantages offered by this wonderful investment option. As is evident, MFs are likely to play an important role in investors' portfolios and help them achieve investment goals in a tax-efficient manner. However, it will be imperative for them to follow the right strategies, stay committed to their time horizon and enhance their awareness about various factors that can influence the final outcome.

Here are a few factors that can not only help you begin your investment process well but also go a long way in helping you analyse the performance, ensuring consistency in the portfolio performance and keeping your investment process on track through a defined time horizon.

Portfolio diversification - Asset allocation is a method that ensures a proper blend of different asset classes in the portfolio and that too in the right proportion. In other words, asset allocation helps in controlling risk in the portfolio as different asset classes react differently to the factors that impact market conditions such as inflation, geo-political issues, rising or falling interest rates or a market segment coming into or falling out of favour.

The key is to understand that asset allocation is different from simple diversification. While having a few funds in the same asset class would provide diversification in your portfolio, it will not control the risk in the manner that an appropriate allocation to different asset classes such as debt, equity, gold, REITs and InvITs would do.

Mutual funds are the most appropriate vehicle to practise asset allocation successfully. They not only provide diversification but also offer a 'family of funds' to suit investment objectives of different age groups with varied time horizons and occupations. Moreover, they also provide opportunities to re-balance the portfolio, which may be required as a result of changes in the circumstances.

Total return - Total return is a measure that captures the overall performance of your portfolio. It includes all forms of returns, capital gains and dividends. This measure is expressed as a per cent of the initial investment amount. Therefore, while selecting funds, you must keep an eye on the total return rather than considering either dividend or change in the NAV alone. By doing so, you can be reasonably sure of having a consistent performer in the portfolio and that can go a long way in achieving your investment objectives.

Beta - 'Beta' is the measure of the relative volatility of a mutual fund scheme to its market usually represented by an index. Beta indicates how much the fund will rise or fall in relation to the changes in the index. To measure the impact, the market has the beta of 1 as the index chosen is the measure of the market movement. If the fund has beta of 0.90, it represents that the fund has gone up (or down) by a factor of 0.90 for every 1 per cent change in the market index. A beta of less than 1 results in lower 'highs' and higher 'lows' than the market.

In other words, a beta can indicate which mutual fund is likely to perform in a consistent manner over a period and which may go like a merry-go-round. It is always helpful to use beta in matching your risk tolerance to the fund you intend to invest in.

Take help of a professional - The complexities in investment process and the vagaries of the markets can be incredibly stressful. An advisor can help you in keeping emotions away from your decision-making process and reduce the financial stress by explaining different situations and keeping investments on track through your defined time horizon.

Risk Tolerance VS. Risk Capacity: Are They Different?

In the world of investing, risk is often misunderstood. It is not just about how much you are willing to take, but also how much you can truly afford. Many investors overlook this distinction, until markets turn volatile and the difference begins to matter more than returns. Do you really understand your ability to take risk? And are risk capacity and risk tolerance the same in your view? If you think so, this is something you cannot afford to miss

When Markets Test You, Not Your Portfolio

Every investor begins with a sense of control. There is a plan, a carefully chosen mix of assets, and a belief that risk is understood. But markets have a way of exposing the gaps in that understanding. Not when things are going well, but when they are not. Imagine a sudden market correction. News flows turn negative, portfolios shrink, and conversations shift from returns to damage control.

The numbers on your screen are no longer abstract. They begin to affect your mood, your decisions, and sometimes even your sleep. This is where two quietly powerful forces come into play - risk tolerance and risk capacity. Most investors use these terms interchangeably, but they are fundamentally different. One lives in your mind, the other in your financial reality. And the difference between them often determines whether you build wealth or struggle with inconsistency.

Risk Tolerance: The Emotional Barometer

Risk tolerance is about how much volatility you can endure without losing your composure. It is not defined by spreadsheets or financial models. It is defined by your reactions. Some investors can watch their portfolio decline significantly and remain calm, trusting the long-term process. Others feel discomfort even when markets move slightly against them. This emotional threshold varies widely and is shaped by personality, experience, and exposure.

Interestingly, risk tolerance often appears inflated during bull markets. When portfolios are rising, volatility feels distant and manageable. Confidence builds quickly. But this confidence is often untested. The first meaningful correction tends to reveal the true level of comfort with risk. An investor who believed they were aggressive may suddenly become cautious. Another who claimed to be conservative may surprise themselves with resilience. Risk tolerance, in many ways, is only truly understood in difficult times.

Risk Capacity: The Financial Foundation

Risk capacity, unlike risk tolerance, is grounded in financial reality. It reflects an investor's ability to take risk without compromising long-term goals. This is not driven by emotions, but by tangible factors such as income stability, existing obligations, investment horizon, and the nature of financial goals. For instance, a young professional with a steady income, minimal liabilities, and a long runway for wealth creation typically has a high-risk capacity. Market volatility, in such cases, can be absorbed over time, supported by future earnings and compounding.

In contrast, an investor approaching retirement, largely dependent on accumulated savings, operates with limited risk capacity. Any significant drawdown at this stage can disrupt financial security and delay critical goals. In essence, risk capacity defines the outer limit of risk an investor can prudently assume. It answers a fundamental question that should guide every portfolio decision: how much risk can you truly afford to take?

The Behavioural Trap in Investing

A key reason investors often misjudge themselves is their tendency to overestimate risk tolerance, particularly during rising markets. Gains create confidence, making volatility seem easier to handle than it truly is. This is largely driven by recency bias, where recent positive experiences shape expectations of the future. Social influence further amplifies this behaviour, as investors feel compelled to match the high returns achieved by others. At the same time, financial planning is often approached mechanically, focusing on numbers rather than emotional resilience, resulting in portfolios that appear optimal on paper but are difficult to sustain in reality.

This overconfidence becomes particularly evident during bullish phases. As optimism builds, investors gradually increase exposure to riskier assets, often without fully recognising the shift. What begins as a balanced allocation can turn aggressive over time. This is especially dangerous for those with limited risk capacity, as financial obligations remain unchanged regardless of market conditions. When markets reverse, portfolios that once felt manageable can quickly become a source of stress and anxiety.

Comfort vs. Capacity: The Hidden Conflict in Investing

Rahul, aged 29, works in the technology sector. He has a stable income, no major liabilities, and a long investment horizon. Financially, he is well-positioned to take risk. However, he monitors his portfolio frequently and becomes anxious during market fluctuations. Pradeep, aged 48, runs a business and has two children approaching higher education. His financial responsibilities are significant, and his investment horizon for key goals is relatively shorter. Despite this, he is confident and comfortable taking bold positions in equities. A closer look at their profiles reveals the contrast:

Particulars	Rahul (Age 29)	Pradeep (Age 48)
Income Stability	High	Moderate
Financial Obligations	Low	High
Investment Horizon	20+ years	8-10 years
Risk Capacity	High	Low to Moderate
Risk Tolerance	Low	High
Actual Portfolio Choice	Conservative	Aggressive
Likely Outcome	Misses long-term wealth creation	Faces risk of capital erosion

Now consider a scenario where the market corrects by 25 per cent. Rahul's conservative portfolio declines modestly, perhaps in the range of 8 to 10 per cent. He feels relieved that his losses are limited. However, when markets recover, his portfolio participates only marginally. Over time, this leads to slower wealth creation. Pradeep's aggressive portfolio, on the other hand, declines sharply, potentially close to 30 per cent. While he may remain emotionally composed, the financial impact is significant. With important goals approaching, the ability to recover from such losses becomes uncertain. This is the essence of the problem. Rahul had the capacity but lacked tolerance. Pradeep had the tolerance but lacked capacity. The result is a mismatch that can affect long-term outcomes.

Understanding Your Position

A useful way to visualize this is through a simple matrix:

Particulars	High-Risk Tolerance	Low-Risk Tolerance
High-Risk Capacity	Ideal zone with discipline	Missed return potential
Low-Risk Capacity	Overexposure and hidden danger	Safe but lower returns

The goal is not to be in the most aggressive quadrant, but in the most aligned one. The ideal zone is where both risk tolerance and risk capacity are high. Here, investors can pursue growth while staying disciplined through market cycles, making it the most effective position for long-term wealth creation. The most dangerous zone is where tolerance is high but capacity is low. Confidence may encourage aggressive bets, but limited financial cushioning means any sharp decline can derail important goals. Equally important is the zone where capacity is high but tolerance is low. Investors here tend to play it too safe despite having the ability to take risk, leading to under-participation in growth and weaker long-term returns. The most stable but least efficient zone is where both tolerance and capacity are low. While portfolios remain relatively protected from volatility, they often struggle to generate meaningful real returns, especially after accounting for inflation.

A Disciplined Approach: Align, Allocate, Act

For investors, the objective is not to chase the highest returns, but to build a portfolio that can be sustained through market cycles without emotional or financial strain. The process begins with alignment. Risk capacity should act as the outer boundary, defining how much risk can be taken without jeopardising financial goals.

Within this framework, risk tolerance determines how that risk is actually deployed. Investors with high capacity but low tolerance are better served by gradually increasing equity exposure, allowing comfort to build over time. Conversely, those with high tolerance but limited capacity must impose discipline, ensuring their portfolios reflect financial realities rather than confidence alone. Asset allocation plays a central role in this balancing act.

A well-diversified portfolio, combining growth-oriented assets with relatively stable ones, allows investors to participate in upside opportunities while cushioning volatility. After all, even the best allocation fails if it cannot be maintained during periods of stress. Time further strengthens this framework. A longer investment horizon enhances the ability to absorb volatility and benefit from compounding.

However, tolerance is shaped not by time alone, but by experience. Investors who stay invested across market cycles gradually develop the confidence to navigate uncertainty with greater ease. Ultimately, behaviour becomes the deciding factor. Frequent shifts in strategy, driven by market noise, often erode returns. When tolerance and capacity are aligned, decision-making becomes more consistent and less reactive. In the end, successful investing is not about timing the market, but about aligning your mindset with your means and staying committed to that balance.

Conclusion

At its core, investing is not just about markets, returns, or timing. It is about knowing yourself just as well as you know your portfolio. The most successful investors are not those who take the highest risks, but those who take risks they can live with and afford to sustain. Before making your next investment decision, pause and ask yourself two simple questions. Can I financially absorb a setback? And equally important, can I emotionally withstand it without reacting impulsively? If both answers are aligned, you are on the right path. In the end, wealth is not created by bold moves alone, but by staying invested with clarity, discipline, and conviction through every phase of the market cycle. Happy investing!

Sorbh Gupta
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"Stay disciplined, diversify sensibly, and keep quality at the centre of every allocation decision."

How are global factors like interest rates, geopolitical tensions, and currency volatility influencing your equity strategy?

Global factors are influencing near-term market behaviour, but they do not alter India's long-term growth story. Elevated interest rate expectations in developed markets are redirecting global capital flows, while geopolitical tensions are fostering risk-off sentiment, and currency volatility is adding an extra layer of uncertainty. We continue to leverage our investment strategy, drawing on deep business research with quantitative discipline and considering investors' behavioural biases during uncertain market phases.

We have always been selective in our portfolio construction, prioritising companies with strong balance sheets, demonstrated pricing capability, and clear earnings visibility. We are also paying closer attention to businesses with significant global revenue exposure, as they carry a different risk profile in these market conditions. This disciplined approach allows us to manage short-term global disruptions while staying invested in businesses that are well-positioned to generate value over the long-term.

Domestic mutual funds have been absorbing heavy FII selling and even deployed large sums during recent corrections. Does this signal a structural shift in market ownership?

Yes, this does reflect a change in how Indian markets are being influenced. Steady growth in SIP inflows and wider retail participation have made domestic mutual funds an important stabilising factor. Having said that, FIIs remain important for India, as they account for 13 per cent of the Indian equities markets despite sustained domestic inflows for over a year and a half. Any positive inflows from FIIs would add further to the positive sentiments of the overall markets.

Is the market transitioning from a broad-based rally to a more stock-specific phase? How should investors adapt?

As markets navigate a phase of transition amid heightened global uncertainty, overall market direction may go sideways over the medium-term. However, such an environment strongly favours stock-specific opportunities, where companies with resilient balance sheets, pricing power, and stable earnings can deliver meaningful returns despite global headwinds. When index returns are weak, bottom-up stock selection tends to be far more effective than broad top-down positioning. Rather than chasing short-term momentum, investors should focus on businesses that can absorb higher costs, protect margins, and generate steady cash flows over time, as disciplined stock picking becomes more important than attempting to time the market.

With increasing interest in international funds after strong performances in select global markets, how should Indian investors approach global diversification?

Global diversification should be seen as a long-term strategy, not something done just because some overseas markets have performed well recently. For Indian investors, adding some international exposure makes sense. It helps reduce over-dependence on Indian markets, offers protection if the Rupee weakens over time, and gives access to global opportunities, especially in areas like technology and healthcare that are limited in India. However, the allocation should match the investor's risk tolerance, investment capacity, and comfort with currency and regulatory differences. A measured allocation to global or regional funds plays a role in balancing and stabilising the portfolio, rather than as a tool to chase higher returns.

If you had to give one portfolio strategy for FY27 to retail investors, what would it be?

Stay disciplined, diversify sensibly, and keep quality at the centre of every allocation decision. Investors should avoid pausing SIPs driven by short-term anxiety and instead remain focused on their long-term financial objectives.

Although near-term market challenges are inevitable, India's growth story remains intact, supported by steady investment activity and strong domestic savings. Building portfolios with a long-term perspective, aligned to individual goals, remains the most effective approach through periods of volatility.